

ENGLISH

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NOTE:

MAKAUT course structure and syllabus of 2nd sem has been changed from 2019. Previously **English Language and Technical Communication [HU 101]** was in 1st semester. This subject has been totally redesigned & restructured as **ENGLISH [HM-HU 201]** in present curriculum. Taking special care of this matter we are providing the relevant MAKAUT university solutions of **English Language and Technical Communication** with some model questions & answers for newly introduced topics, along with the complete solutions of new university papers, so that students can get an idea about university questions patterns.

VOCABULARY BUILDING

Very Short Answer Type Questions

1. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

i) Synonym of 'Auxiliary' is

- a) Conductive b) associate c) Capacity

[WBUT 2007, 2014]
d) authority

Answer: (b)

ii) The word 'impeccable' means

- a) questionable b) faultless c) annoying

[WBUT 2007, 2011]
d) pleasing

Answer: (b)

iii) A place where Government records are kept is called

- a) museum b) archives c) herbarium

[WBUT 2007, 2014, 2017]
d) planetarium

Answer: (b)

iv) The single word for 'a remedy for all diseases' is

- a) aamnesty b) panacea c) amateur

[WBUT 2007, 2014]
d) anarchy

Answer: (b)

2. That which cannot be burnt is

- a) Incombustible b) Inaudible c) Indivisible

[WBUT 2008, 2011, 2017]
d) Inaccessible

Answer: (a)

3. Choose the correct alternatives of the following:

i) The word 'extravagant' is the opposite of

- a) expensive b) unlimited c) thrifty

[WBUT 2009, 2014]
d) proud

Answer: (c)

ii) The synonym of the word 'Tyranny' is

- a) Misrule b) Cruelty c) Tension

[WBUT 2009, 2014]
d) Madness

Answer: (a)

iii) The word *forsake* means the same as

- a) Forgive b) punish c) abandon

[WBUT 2009, 2016]
d) benefit

Answer: (c)

4. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

i) The antonym of 'ruthless' is

- a) renovated b) mighty c) merciful

[WBUT 2011]

d) maximum

Answer: (c)

ii) The synonym of 'rectify' is

- a) remedy b) avenge c) noisy

d) defeat

Answer: (a)

iii) If I king, I would be the happiest man on earth.

- a) was b) were c) am d) be

Answer: (b)

iv) I recommend that he at once.

- a) apologize b) apologizes c) apologized d) apologizing

Answer: (a)

v) The word 'unintelligible' means

- a) not intelligent b) not reasonable c) annoying d) not understood

Answer: (d)

vi) The single word for 'A paper written by hand' is

- a) manuscript b) handbook c) notebook d) script

Answer: (a)

vii) One living with the same time with another is

- a) temporary b) contemporary c) permanent d) none of these

[WBUT 2011, 2014]

Answer: (b)

viii) In the long run an increase in number of vehicles causes oil consumption to rise faster than oil production resulting in the of oil supplies.

- a) shrinking b) squeezing c) depleting d) freezing

Answer: (c)

5. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

[WBUT 2012]

i) The antonym of 'obscure' is

- a) indistinct b) hazy c) clear

[WBUT 2012, 2017]

d) dull

Answer: (c)

ii) The synonym of 'eradicate' is

- a) see b) happen c) remove d) accept

Answer: (c)

iii) His brother is Ambidextrous. Here ambidextrous means

- a) can use either his right or his left hand equally well
b) has a serious vitamin deficiency
c) is too concerned with details
d) none of these

Answer: (a)

6. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

[WBUT 2013]

i) A detailed narrative is

- a) Chronicle b) Novel c) Epic d) Story

Answer: (c)

- ii) The antonym of 'Grotesque' is
a) Strange b) Normal

c) Terrifying

d) Absurd

Answer: (b)

- iii) The synonym of 'sagacity' is
a) morality b) wisdom

c) sanity

d) uprightness

Answer: (b)

- iv) The bride looked radiant as she walked down the
a) aisle b) isle

c) alley

d) corner

Answer: (a)

- v) The earthquake warnings and the fragility of our houses make us certain that disaster is

a) imminent

b) forthcoming

c) eminent

d) expected

Answer: (a)

- vi) It is no easy job to the anger of this hot-headed man.

a) satiate

b) mollify

c) heighten

d) pacify

Answer: (d)

7. Answer all questions.

[WBUT 2014]

- i) To make the house more comfortable, we have decided to have central heating

a) installed

b) established

c) settled

d) involved

Answer: (a)

- ii) To put down in black and white means

a) to distinguish clearly

c) to seal the envelope

b) to write down on paper

d) to tell the truth

Answer: (b)

8. Answer all questions.

[WBUT 2015]

- i) The synonym of 'ethnic' is

a) coloured

b) racial

c) prejudiced

d) tribal

Answer: (b)

- ii) The antonym of 'global' is

a) international

b) worldwide

c) zonal

d) local

Answer: (d)

9. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

[WBUT 2016]

- i) That which cannot be corrected is

a) Unintelligible

b) Indelible

c) Illegible

d) Incurable

Answer: (b)

ii) The antonym of the word 'Indelible' is
a) Lasting b) Fixed

c) Erasable

d) Unforgettable

Answer: (c)

iii) The meaning of reticent is
a) Quiet b) Quite

c) Quit

d) Quotient

Answer: (a)

iv) Laudable means
a) Commendable b) Dependable

c) Explicable

d) Debatable

Answer: (a)

v) V. S. Naipaul is a/an writer.
a) Eminent b) imminent

c) prominent

d) dominant

Answer: (a)

10. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

[WBUT 2017]

i) The synonym for the word 'inadvertently' is
a) occasionally b) unintentionally c) deliberately

d) curiously

Answer: (b)

ii) The word autonomy means
a) democracy b) self-rule

c) aristocracy

d) coalition

Answer: (b)

iii) The word 'impeccable' means
a) questionable b) practical

c) flawless

d) affordable

Answer: (c)

11. Choose the correct alternatives for the following:

[WBUT 2019]

i) The universe was formed out of chaos. The antonym of 'chaos' is
a) Dystopia b) Cosmos c) Hullabaloo

d) Topsy-turvy

Answer: (b)

ii) Virat Kohli has penchant for hook shots. The synonym of 'penchant' is

a) Art

b) Inclination

c) Strength

d) Desire

Answer: (b)

iii) Words written on the tomb of a person

a) manuscript

b) inscription

c) epitaph

d) engrave

Answer: (c)

12. Write the antonyms of the following adjectives.

[WBUT 2023]

a) Ancient

b) Doubtful

Answer: a) Contemporary; b) Sure

Short Answer Type Questions

1. Make into sentence two homonyms:

a) Cereal, Serial.

b) Bear, Bare

Answer:

a) **Cereal**- One of Americans most popular breakfast is cereals of various flavours

Serial- Maintaining serial order is an important part of army discipline

b) **Bear**- To bear the burden of educating all his siblings after his father's death was not easy for the 18-year old teenager.

Bare- the bare back of the malnourished labour was scorched by the sun while unloading the truck.

[WBUT 2023]

Long Answer Type Questions

1. Write different techniques of word-formation. Elucidate at least five such techniques with proper example.

[WBUT 2019]

Answer:

In linguistics, word formation is the creation of a new word. Word formation is sometimes contrasted with semantic change, which is a change in a single word's meaning. The boundary between word formation and semantic change can be difficult to define: a new use of an old word can be seen as a new word derived from an old one and identical to it in form.

Compounding: Compounding forms a word out of two or more root morphemes. The words are called compounds or compound words. In Linguistics, compounds can be either native or borrowed. Native English roots are typically free morphemes, so that means native compounds are made out of independent words that can occur by themselves. Examples: *mailman* (composed of free root *mail* and free root *man*). Compounds are written in various ways in English: with a space between the elements; with a hyphen between the elements; or simply with the two roots run together with no separation. The way the word is written does not affect its status as a compound. Over time, the convention for writing compounds can change, usually in the direction from separate words (e.g. *email* used to be written with a hyphen. In the 19th century, today and tomorrow were sometimes still written *to-day* and *to-morrow*. The *to* originally was the preposition *to* with an older meaning 'at [a particular period of time]'. *Clock work* changed to *clock-work* and finally to one word with no break (*clockwork*). If you read older literature you might see some compound words that are now written as one word appearing with unfamiliar spaces or hyphens between the components. Another thing to note about compounds is that they can combine words of different parts of speech, such as adjective-noun (*dry run*, *blackbird*, *hard drive*), verb-noun (*pick-pocket*, *cut-purse*, *lick-spittle*) and even verb-particle (where 'particle' means a word basically designating spatial expression that functions to complete a literal or metaphorical path), as in *run-through*, *hold-over*.

Derivation: Derivation is the creation of words by modification of a root without the addition of other roots. Often the effect is a change in part of speech.

Blending: Two words are merged based not on morpheme structure but on sound structure. The resulting words are called blends. Usually in word formation we combine roots or affixes along their edges: one morpheme comes to an end before the next one starts. For example, we form *derivation* out of the sequence of morphemes *de+riv+at(e)+ion*. One morpheme follows the next and each one has identifiable boundaries. The morphemes do not overlap. But in blending, part of one word is stitched onto another word, without any regard for where one morpheme ends and another begins. For example, the word *swooshtika* 'Nike swoosh as a logo symbolizing corporate power and hegemony' was formed from *swoosh* and *swastika*. The *swoosh* part remains whole and recognizable in the blend, but the *tika* part is not a morpheme, either in the word *swastika* or in the blend. Some blends that have been around for quite a while include *brunch* (breakfast and lunch), *motel* (motor hotel), *electrocute* (electric and execute), *smog* (smoke and fog) and *cheeseburger* (cheese and hamburger).

Clipping: Clipping is a type of abbreviation of a word in which one part is 'clipped' off the rest, and the remaining word now means essentially the same thing as what the whole word means or meant. For example, the word *rifle* is a fairly modern clipping of an earlier compound *rifle gun*, meaning a gun with a rifled barrel. (*Rifled* means having a spiral groove causing the bullet to spin, and thus making it more accurate.) Another clipping is *burger*, formed by clipping off the beginning of the word *hamburger*. (This clipping could only come about once *hamburg+er* was reanalyzed as *ham+burger*.)

Acronyms: Acronyms are formed by taking the initial letters of a phrase and making a word out of it. Acronyms provide a way of turning a phrase into a word. The classical acronym is also pronounced as a word. *Scuba* was formed from *self-contained underwater breathing apparatus*. Some organizations ARE pronounced as a word: UNICEF, MADD (Mothers Against Drunk Driving)

Analogy: Sometimes speakers take an existing word as a model and form other words using some of its morphemes as a fixed part, and changing one of them to something new, with an analogically similar meaning. *Cheeseburger* was formed on the analogy of *hamburger*, replacing a perceived morpheme *ham* with *cheese*. *carjack* and *skyjack* were also formed by analogy.

Novel creation: In novel creation, a speaker or writer forms a word without starting from other morphemes. It is as if the word is formed out of 'whole cloth', without reusing any parts. Some examples of now-conventionalized words that were novel creations include *blimp*, *googol* (the mathematical term), *bling*, and possibly *slang*, which emerged in the last 200 years with no obvious etymology. Some novel creations seem to display 'sound symbolism', in which a word's phonological form suggests its meaning in some way. For example, the sound of the word *bling* seems to evoke heavy jewelry making noise. Another novel creation whose sound seems to relate to its meaning is *badonkadonk*, 'female rear end', a reduplicated word which can remind English speakers of the repetitive movement of the rear end while walking

POPULAR PUBLICATIONS

2. a) What do you understand about compounding? What is compounding in word formation? Give examples? [WBUT 2023]

Answer:

In grammar, *compounding*, also called *composition*, is when two or more words are combined together to form a new word. For example, the word *underground* is a combination of the words *under* and *ground*. In English, *compounding* is used to form words belonging to four common parts of speech: nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs. Most of the time, compounding creates a word or phrase that means something different than the meanings of the words used as "ingredients". For example, the word *blue bird* refers to specific species of songbirds whereas the separate words *blue bird* refer to any bird with blue feathers. As another example, the adjective *old school* refers to supporting traditional methods or values and doesn't refer to ancient scholarly buildings.

b) What is Backformation in word formation process? Give examples.

Answer:

In linguistics, *back-formation* is the process of forming a new word (a neologism) by removing actual or supposed affixes from another word. Put simply, a back-formation is a shortened word (such as *edit*) created from a longer word (*editor*). Also called *back-derivation*. Examples:

- singular noun *pea* from the older English plural *pease*
- the verb *burgle* from the older English noun *burglar*
- the verb *diagnose* from the older English noun *diagnosis*

c) What is the difference between backformation and clipping?

Answer:

Back-formation varies from clipping – back-formation may change the word's class or meaning, whereas clipping creates shortened words from longer words, but does not change the class or meaning of the word. Clipping is usually used due to high frequency of use in communication. E.g. exam, info, demo. Back formation is a process whereby a word whose form is similar that to of a derived form undergoes a process of deaffixation. E.g. donation-donate, embody-body

d) What is Blending? What is an example of Blending word parts?

Answer:

It refers to joining the beginning of one word and the end of another to make a new word with a new meaning. It refers to the process of combining the sounds and meanings of two words to create a new one. The phenomenon is also called fusion. It is a common way of expanding the vocabulary in English and involves merging two different words in such a way that the characteristics of the two are still recognizable. Example Smog, from smoke and fog, and brunch, from breakfast and lunch, are examples of blends.

BASIC WRITING SKILLS

Very Short Answer Type Questions

1. I request you to your crime. (Choose the most effective word to make a meaningful sentence) [WBUT 2014]
 a) apologies b) agree c) confess d) pardon

Answer: (c)

2. The Sun set before we reached the village. (Improve the sentence) [WBUT 2014]
 a) had set b) would set
 c) would have set d) no improvement

Answer: (a)

3. He succeeded _____ perseverance and sheer hard work. [WBUT 2015, 2016]
 a) instead of b) by dint of c) by reason of d) in the event of

Answer: (b)

4. Despite the millions of dollars spent on improvements, the transport system in India remains _____ and continues to _____ the citizens who depend on it. [WBUT 2015]
 a) primitive....inconvenience b) bombastic....upset
 c) suspicious....connect d) outdated....elate

Answer: (a)

5. An agenda comes with [WBUT 2017]
 a) notice b) memorandum c) report d) sales letter

Answer: (a)

6. Read the sentence and select the option that corrects the underlined section: [WBUT 2019]
 Quebec risers in a magnificent way above the St. Lawrence River.

- a) Rises in a magnificent way, way above
 b) Rises magnificently above
 c) Is raised in a magnificent way above
 d) No change

Answer: (b)

7. Choose the answer that corrects the misplaced phrase in this sentence, if required: [WBUT 2019]
 Wearing a skirt, Bill Bates gave chocolates to the little girl and her brother.

- a) Bill Bates gave chocolate wearing a skirt to the little girl and her brother
 b) Bill Bates gave chocolates to the little girl and her brother wearing a skirt
 c) Bill Bates gave chocolates to the little girl wearing a skirt and her brother
 d) no change

Answer: (c)

8. I saw nothing in the bag but husks and dust. (Make the sentence affirmative)
[WBUT 2023]

Answer: I saw only husks and dust in the bag.

9. Make into sentence the following idiom: Road block
[WBUT 2023]

Answer:

The investigator reached a road block when the hospital refused to hand him over the post mortem report of the unknown assailant without proper paperwork.

10. Nobody had seen her smile. (Change the voice)
[WBUT 2023]

Answer: She has not been seen smiling by anybody.

11. The neighbours looked with vast admiration at the things which Issac manufactured. (Change the voice)
[WBUT 2023]

Answer:

Things manufactured by Issac were looked upon by the neighbours with vast admiration

Short Answer Type Questions

1. Do as directed:

[WBUT 2011]

i) Pay me, or I shall send you to jail. (Rewrite beginning with: *Unless*)

ii) I am writing in reply to your letter that I received two days ago.

(Rewrite beginning with: *I received*)

iii) I feel bored and I went out for a walk.

(Rewrite beginning with: *Feeling*)

iv) I refuse to answer any of your questions.

(Rewrite beginning with: *She said*)

v) I strongly believe that privation is the only solution.

(Rewrite beginning with: *Solution*)

Answer:

i) Unless you pay me, I shall send you to jail.

ii) I received your letter two days ago and am writing reply to.

iii) Feeling bored, I went out for a walk.

iv) She said that she refused to answer any of my questions.

v) Solution to it is only privation.

2. Express the meaning of each phrasal verb with one meaningful sentence:

[WBUT 2013]

- Pull up
- Let down
- Look for
- Have an edge
- Create a benchmark

Answer:

- **Pull up** - Ritesh needs to pull up his socks and perform if he wants to pass the annual semester.

- **Let down** – Revathi needs to let down her hair once in a while and let go else she will actually succumb to the work pressure.
- **Look for** – Ravi needs to look for a better employment opportunity for himself as he is being underutilized here.
- **Have an edge** – Acquiring an MBA degree ensures having an edge over others in this highly competitive marketing industry.
- **Create a benchmark** – Ramesh has created a benchmark in his college with his latest academic and co-curricular performances.

3. Rewrite the paragraph with proper punctuation marks: [WBUT 2019]
 One morning a boy tending cattle by the side of a railway line noticed that a small railway bridge had given way under the previous nights heavy torrential shower he also saw a passenger in the distance coming towards it at full speed a simple cowboy as he was he at once realized the great danger

Answer:

One morning, a boy tending cattle by the side of a railway line noticed that a small railway bridge had given way under the previous night's heavy torrential shower. He also saw a passenger in the distance coming towards it at full speed. A simple cowboy as he was, he at once realized the great danger.

4. Give an example according to this structure. [WBUT 2023]

Subject + Verb + Subject complement

Answer: The new teacher seems efficient.

5. Subject + Infinitive verb. (Construct a sentence) [WBUT 2023]

Answer: I want to be an astronaut.

Long Answer Type Questions

1. Write down the different techniques of writing precisely. Use suitable examples to support your answer. [WBUT 2019]

Answer:

In academic writing it is essential that your readers - and markers - understand exactly what you mean, so you need to make sure that what you write is accurate and unambiguous. This is not as simple as it sounds; writing precisely requires considerable thought and careful editing.

1. **Use Active Voice:** When a sentence includes *be* or any other copulative verb, such as *is* or *are*, recast the sentence to omit the verb.

Before: "The meeting was seen by us as a ploy to delay the project."

After: "We saw the meeting as a ploy to delay the project."

2. **Avoid Vague Nouns:** Phrases formed around general nouns such as *aspect*, *degree*, and *situation* clutter sentences.

Before: "She is an expert in the area of international relations."

After: "She is an expert in international relations."

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3. **Use Words, Not Their Definitions:** Replace explanatory phrases with a single word that encapsulates that explanation.
Before: "The crops also needed to be marketable so that families would be able to sell any yields that exceeded what they personally required."
After: "The crops also needed to be marketable so that families would be able to sell any surplus."
4. **Avoid Noun Strings:** Reorganize sentences to eliminate series of nouns used as adjectives.
Before: "The lack of a secure transfer may hamper computer security incident response efforts."
After: "The lack of a secure transfer may hamper responses to computer-security incidents."
5. **Convert Nouns to Verbs:** When a sentence includes a noun ending in **-tion**, change the noun to a verb to simplify the sentence.
Before: "They will collaborate in the creation of new guidelines."
After: "They will collaborate to create new guidelines."
6. **Reduce Verb Phrases to Simple Verbs:** Identify the verb buried in a verb phrase and omit the rest of the phrase.
Before: "The results are suggestive of the fact that tampering has occurred."
After: "The results suggest that tampering has occurred."
7. **Replace Complex Words with Simple Ones:** Choose simpler synonyms for multisyllabic words.
Before: "The department will disseminate the forms soon."
After: "The department will pass out the forms soon."
8. **Avoid Expletives:** Don't start sentences with "There is," "There are," or "It is."
Before: "There are many factors in the product's failure."
After: "Many factors contributed to the product's failure."
9. **Eliminate Prepositional Phrases:** Replace "(noun1) of the (noun2)" phrasing with "(noun2)'s (noun1)" phrasing.
Before: "The decision of the committee is final."
After: "The committee's decision is final."
10. **Reduce Wordy Phrases to Single Words:** Replace phrases that signal a transition with simple conjunctions, verbs, or other linking words.
Before: Due to the fact that the project is behind schedule, today's meeting has been postponed.
After: Because the project is behind schedule, today's meeting has been postponed.

2. a) The followers of the king had often praised him to his face. They hated him for his cruelties and vices. They deserted him in the hour of need. [WBUT 2023]
(Combine the above set of sentences into one simple sentence)

Answer:

The followers of the king had often praised him to his face, but deserted him in the hour of need, hating him for his cruelties and vices.

b) Aristotle was a great philosopher. He wrote many learned books. He devised a new system of logic. He had nevertheless been accused of doing many things unworthy of his high position. (Combine into a simple sentence)

Answer:

Aristotle, a great philosopher who wrote many learned books and devised a new system of logic, had been accused of doing many things unworthy of his high position.

c) People who live in a glass houses should not throw stones at one another. (Turn into a simple sentence)

Answer:

People living in glass houses should not throw stones at one another.

d) Uneasy lies the crowned head. (Turn a complex sentence)

Answer: Uneasy lies the head that wears the crown.

e) Speak the truth. (Turn a complex sentence)

Answer: Speak what the truth is.

f) Besides caning the boy he also fined him. (Turn into compound sentence)

Answer: He caned the boy and also fined him.

g) If you do not work you will fail. (Turn into compound sentence)

Answer: You need to work, otherwise you will fail.

h) I am sure you are wrong. (Turn into compound sentences)

Answer: I am sure and you are wrong.

3. a) Rewrite the sentences as directed:

[WBUT 2023]

The Romans expected to conquer Carthage. (Change the sentence into a passive form)

Answer: Carthage was expected to be conquered by the Romans.

b) I shall be obliged to go. (Change the sentence into the active form)

Answer: Circumstances will oblige me to go.

c) Dr. Livingstone I presume (Put the punctuation mark)

Yes said he with a kind smile lifting his cap slightly.

Answer:

"Dr. Livingstone I presume".

"Yes", said he with a kind smile, lifting his cap slightly.

d) Oh sir said Ram I am sorry if I have disturbed you. (Put the punctuation)

Answer: "Oh, Sir!", said Ram. "I am sorry if I have disturbed you"

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e) Change the sentence to indirect:

"I cannot understand why the spring is so late in coming", said the Selfish Giant.
Answer: The Selfish Giant wondered why the spring was so late in coming,

f) Change the sentence to direct speech:

Socrates said that he was a citizen, not of Athens, but of the world.
Answer: "I am a citizen of the world, not of Athens", said Socrates.

g) Change the sentence into indirect speech:

"Swallow, Swallow, little Swallow," said the Prince, "will you not stay with me one night and be my messenger? The boy is so thirsty and the mother is so sad."

Answer:

The Prince asked the Swallow if it would stay one night with him and be his messenger as the boy was so thirsty and the mother was so sad,

h) Change the sentence to indirect speech:

Alexander said to Porus, "How do you desire to be treated?" "Like a king". "And you have nothing else to request?" replied Alexander. "No".

Answer:

Alexander asked Porus how he desired to be treated, to which Porus answered that he would like to be treated as a king. Alexander once again asked if there was any other request to which Porus said no.

IDENTIFYING COMMON ERRORS IN WRITING

Very Short Answer Type Questions

1. I depended on you for support. But you let me [WBUT 2010, 2017]
 a) out b) off c) down d) out
 Answer: (c)
2. "with a view to top performance, we hire the best quality managers". The correct word in the blank should be [WBUT 2012]
 a) ensure b) ensuring c) ensured d) none of these
 Answer: (b)
3. Everybody entitled to one month's salary as bonus. [WBUT 2012, 2016, 2017]
 a) is b) were c) be d) are
 Answer: (a)
4. He was found desperately for his life. [WBUT 2012]
 a) fought b) fighting c) fights d) fight
 Answer: (b)
5. The boots are the shelf. [WBUT 2013]
 a) under b) down c) in d) over
 Answer: (c)
6. All the employees of the firm are to a fortnight's holiday. [WBUT 2013]
 a) allowed b) entitled c) required d) able
 Answer: (b)
7. A hedonist is fond the good things in life. [WBUT 2013]
 a) about b) of c) for d) regarding
 Answer: (b)
8. It is better to be than make a blunder. [WBUT 2013, 2019]
 a) discreet b) discrete c) discard d) competent
 Answer: (b)
9. I wish you that photo. It was a rare one of my grandparents' wedding in 1928. [WBUT 2015]
 a) hasn't b) haven't taken c) hadn't taken d) won't have taken
 Answer: (c)

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10. People usually _____ to the radio in the early 1980s.
a) listen b) listened c) had listened

[WBUT 2015]
d) have listened

Answer: (b)

11. If I _____ king, I would be the happiest man on earth.
a) was b) were c) am

[WBUT 2015]
d) be

Answer: (b)

12. I recommend that he _____ at once.
a) apologize b) apologizes c) apologized

[WBUT 2015]
d) apologizing

Answer: (b)

13. The victim _____ me, "Could you show me the way?"
a) commanded b) suggested c) asked

[WBUT 2015]
d) advised

Answer: (c)

14. We went _____ a holiday to Gopalpur-on-Sea last December.
a) on b) to c) around

[WBUT 2015]
d) from

Answer: (a)

15. People said she died cholera.
a) for b) of c) in

[WBUT 2017]
d) by

Answer: (b)

16. A large scale departure of people from a territory is
a) Migration b) Immigration c) Exodus

[WBUT 2019]
d) Aberration

Answer: (c)

17. Bangladesh into existence 30 years ago.
a) had come b) came c) was come

[WBUT 2019]
d) is come

Answer: (b)

18. The Engineer along with the overseer visited the proposed
a) site b) side c) sight

[WBUT 2019]
d) shrine

Answer: (a)

19. The thief before the police arrived.
a) escaped b) had escaped c) did escape

[WBUT 2019]
d) was escaping

Answer: (a)

20. Understanding someone as a doctor by the stethoscope is an example of

a) pragmatics b) sign-language c) chronemics

[WBUT 2019]
d) artifact

Answer: (a)

21. He nearly drove the car for six hours a day. (Correct the sentence) [WBUT 2023]

Answer: He drove the car for nearly six hours a day.

22. The audience of a football match are pleased when a goal is made. (Correct the sentence) [WBUT 2023]

Answer: The spectators of a football match are pleased when a goal is scored.

23. I enjoyed the beauty of the nature. (Correct the answer) [WBUT 2023]

Answer: I enjoyed the beauty of nature

24. He spoke a lie. (Correct the sentence) [WBUT 2023]

Answer: He uttered a lie.

Short Answer Type Questions

1. What are redundancies? Elucidate with proper examples. [WBUT 2019]

Answer:

Redundancy is defined as a dismissal caused by either the company is closing down, downsizing or the employees job is no longer needed or been done. The responsibility of the employer is to show evidence that redundancy is required. They cannot just decide redundancy is required. An employee shall be taken to be dismissed by reason of redundancy if the dismissal is attributable wholly or mainly to: the fact that his employer has ceased or intends to cease to carry on the business for the purposes of which the employee was employed by him, or has ceased or intends to cease, to carry on that business in the place where the employee was so employed, or the fact that the requirements of that business for employees to carry out work of a particular kind in the place where he was so employed have ceased or diminished or are expected to cease or diminish, or the fact that his employer has decided to carry on the business with fewer or no employees whether by requiring the work for which the employee has been employed (or had been doing before his dismissal) to be done by other employees or otherwise, or the fact that his employer had decided that the work for which the employee has been employed (or had been doing before his dismissal) should henceforth be done in a different manner for which the employee is not sufficiently qualified or trained, or the fact that his employer has decided that the work for which the employee has been employed (or had been doing before his dismissal) should henceforth be done by a person who is capable of doing other work for which the employee is not sufficiently qualified or trained.

2. Fill in the blanks with appropriate prepositions: [WBUT 2019]

- This material is different that.
- You should explain these them.
- He has been absent Monday.
- I have not been to the theatre a long time.
- This is a comfortable house to life

Answer:

- a) from b) to c) since d) in e) in

3. Correct the following sentences:

[WBUT 2023]

- a) They met some day to discuss it.
b) There will be a break of fifteen minutes between each session.

Answer:

- a) They met one day to discuss it.
b) There will be a break of fifteen minutes between two sessions.

Long Answer Type Questions

1. a) Insert appropriate prepositions:

[WBUT 2011]

- i) People said she died cholera.
ii) Don't loiter the corridor.
iii) The apple is sweet taste.
iv) I am fed with your habit for complaining.
v) People say he has a passion arguing.

Answer:

- i) of, ii) in, iii) to, iv) up, v) for

b) Correct the grammatical errors:

[WBUT 2011]

- i) My most favourite game is cricket.
ii) Despite of my qualification I could not get a job.
iii) The dinner was same as usual.
iv) The Dean of Student Welfare met of the representatives from the student union.
v) I have applied for a visa for the American Embassy.

Answer:

- i) My favourite game is cricket.
ii) In spite of my qualification I could not get a job.
iii) The dinner was same.
iv) The Dean of Student Welfare met with the representatives of the student union.
v) I have applied for a visa to the American Embassy.

2. i) It is high time government do something in this matter. (Correct a sentence)

[WBUT 2023]

Answer: It is high time the government does something in this matter.

ii) It is raining for a week. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: It is raining since one week.

iii) The Earth is moving round the Sun. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: The Earth is revolving around the Sun.

iv) I have arrived yesterday. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: I arrived yesterday.

v) I have seen my friend long ago. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: I have not seen my friend for a long time.

vi) You are not understanding my difficulties. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: You are unable to understand my difficulties.

vii) Try hard so that you might win. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: Try hard and you might win.

viii) He absented from the meeting. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: He was absent from the meeting.

ix) He prides on his success. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: He takes pride in his success.

x) No boy in the class is so good as Amal. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: No boy in the class is as good as Amal.

xi) I feel myself unwell. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: I feel unwell.

xii) This is more preferable than that. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: This is preferable to that.

xiii) Which do you prefer most? (Correct a sentence)

Answer: Which do you prefer?

xiv) The economical position of the country is bad. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: The economic position of the country is bad.

xv) It is a clouded day. (Correct a sentence)

Answer: It is a cloudy day.

[WBUT 2023]

3. a) Put the article (a, an, the) in the proper place:

1) I have great deal of work to do. (Correct the sentence)

2) The magistrate failed to keep peace. (Correct the sentence)

3) I took short sleep. (Correct the sentence)

4) This is slip of tongue. (Correct the sentence)

5) He made a fun of it. (Correct the sentence)

Answer:

1) I have a great deal of work to do.

2) The magistrate failed to keep the peace.

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- 3) I took a short sleep.
- 4) This is a slip of tongue.
- 5) He made fun of it.

b) Put preposition if needed:

- 1) He is absent at the meeting. (Correct the sentence)
- 2) He is confined in bed. (Correct the sentence)
- 3) Cats live by milk. (Correct the sentence)
- 4) He is good in mathematics. (Correct the sentence)
- 5) There is no end of troubles. (Correct the sentence)

Answer:

- 1) He is absent from the meeting.
- 2) He is confined to bed.
- 3) Cats live off milk.
- 4) He is good at mathematics.
- 5) There is no end to troubles.

c) What is the difference between misplaced and dangling modifiers?

Answer:

A misplaced modifier is a modifier that is positioned too far away from the word, phrase or clause it is intended to modify and, as a result, appears to be modifying something else. A misplaced modifier can be fixed by moving it so that it is connected to the right subject.

- Wrong: The waiter presented a steak to the guest that was medium rare.
- Corrected: The waiter presented a medium-rare steak to the guest.

A dangling modifier occurs when the subject of a modifier is missing from the sentence. Dangling modifiers often take the form of an introductory phrase followed by a clause that doesn't state the intended subject.

- Wrong: Fumbling in her purse, the keys could not be found.
- Corrected: Fumbling in her purse, she could not find the keys.

NATURE AND STYLE OF SENSIBLE WRITING

Very Short Answer Type Questions

1. What are the elements of sensible writing?

[WBUT 2023]

Answer:

Clarity, Concision, Precision - Say what you mean, as clearly and concisely as possible. Vagueness or ambiguity suggests to the reader that you're not sure what you're writing about.

Short Answer Type Questions

1. Rearrange the following sentences in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph; then answer the questions given below them.

- A. One evidence of this is that many highly intelligent people are very low on creativity.
- B. In other words they may find replicating a process very easy but creating a process difficult.
- C. But it is unfortunate that in many organizations these replicates are rated high and promoted over creators.
- D. Intelligence and creativity are two different things.
- E. They may understand the things very fast but are poor if any new thing is to be developed; this in the long-term gives creators an upper edge.

- a) Which of the above will be the second sentence?
- b) Which of the above will be the fifth sentence?
- c) Which of the above will be the fourth sentence?
- d) Which of the above will be the first sentence?
- e) Which of the above will be the third sentence?

[WBUT 2019]

Answer:

Intelligence and creativity are two different things.

One evidence of this is that many highly intelligent people are very low on creativity.

They may understand the things very fast but are poor if any new thing is to be developed; this in the long-term gives creators an upper edge.

In other words they may find replicating a process very easy but creating a process difficult.

- a) A
- b) C
- c) B
- d) D
- e) E

2. What is an extended definition?

[WBUT 2023]

Answer:

In a paragraph, essay, or speech, an extended definition is an explanation and/or illustration of a word, thing, or concept.

An extended definition is a definition that goes beyond a dictionary.com or a Merriam Webster definition. In contrast, extended definitions are lengthier and are more detailed definitions.

3. What do you understand by description writing? Give example. [WBUT 2023]

Answer:

Descriptive writing is writing in which the author's intent is to create a vivid image of what he/she is describing in the mind of the reader. It relies on the author using detailed descriptions that convey the sensory details of what he/she is describing, often with the use of specific techniques. Descriptive writing uses vivid language to create the overall effect that the reader is present in the story.

Example: The colorful flowers brought life to an otherwise lifeless sidewalk. The different shades of the green stems and leaves were the perfect backdrops to the yellow, orange, and red petals that seemed to sway softly with the breeze.

Long Answer Type Questions

1. Discuss in detail the salient features of technical communication and its application in an organization. [WBUT 2010]

OR,

Discuss the features of technical Communication. [WBUT 2013]

Answer:

Communication with people in a Business context often requires a more formal style than when writing to friends and family. Business letters typically avoids spoken language. Written communication should be placed in logical sequence for becoming more effective. Business letters should be simple and short. The choice of tone will depend upon sender, receiver, the occasion and content. The style and tone can be Active, Passive, Personal, Impersonal, Colourful or Colorless. Business letters have the following six parts:

- a) The Heading
- b) Salutation or Greeting
- c) Communication or body of the letter
- d) Subscription or leave taking
- e) The signature of the writer
- f) The superscription or outward address

In the following table the type of communications and their area of applications are given:

Type of Communication	Area of Applications
Memo	Inter office Correspondence
Circulars	Open Communication for all
Sales Letter.	For sales promotion directed to customers
Notice	Open Communication for a office
Inquiry letters	Addressed to vendors
Minutes of Meeting	Record notes of discussions of a meeting
Report	Techno-commercial findings

Type of Communication	Area of Applications
Presentation	Presentation of a report/product/in a seminar
Journals	For a group of persons internal and external to the business
Newsletters	For internal and external customers
Periodicals	For internal and external customers
Newsletters	For internal and external customers
Audited Annual Report	For internal and external customers, shareholders and the Government
Magazines	For internal and external customers

2. Do you feel that electronic means of communication is always advantageous over the traditional means? Explain your answer with suitable examples.

[WBUT 2011]

Answer:

Electronic means of communication is advantageous to traditional means as could be seen from the followings:

- Electronic means of Communication is fast
- It is reliable
- It is paperless and allows maintenance of records in a transparent manner.
- Low cost
- It avoids personal contact and hence personal influence.

This can be explained in the following example:

Filing of a FIR with the concerned Police Station

In traditional means filing of a FIR with concerned Police station requires the complainants to personally visit the concerned Police station and narrate the complaints to the available officer. If the Officer feels that the complaints worth filing a FIR, then he will write the FIR. During the process at least 4/6 hours time will be spent by the Complainant and the police Officer will also spend around 1/2 hours in registering the complaint. The entire process involves personal judgment of the police officer in accepting the complaint as FIR. The officer may reject the proposal and may not entertain a FIR. In this case there is no documentary evidence to show why a FIR was not accepted and recorded. This is likely to promote corruption. Here the police officer may accept a FIR if he is influenced.

In case of e-filing of a FIR, the complainant will be required to write the complaints in an appropriate format and then send a mail. This will be electronically accepted and a reference number will be given. Simultaneously, the mail will be directed to the concerned Police station for their action. If the concerned Police Station does not treat this as FIR, they will explain in detail in their reply mail. Here the time was saved and personal contact was avoided. This process has reduced time for recording complaints and avoided possible corruption.

3. Elaborately discuss the character of Guddava in the story 'The Moon is the Earthen Pot'. Why the story is named so?

[WBUT 2013]

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Answer:

Guddavva was the first wife of Paramati Chengayya. She was living with her parents in Aarepalli rangampetta near Tirupati. She lost her left eye because of wrong treatment when she was young.

Immediately after Guddavva was blessed with a son, his ill behaved short tempered husband married for the second time and severed his connection with Guddavva and the Son. During this time Guddavva had to work very hard and do all types of odd jobs to earn her livelihood and nurture the infant son. The Son gradually grew up under the shelter and Guardianship of Guddavva. Later when the son became young, He left Guddavva, went to his father Paramati Chengayya, married and settled in Rangampeta.

At a later date Guddavva's son brought her back to home, and built a separate hutment for her peaceful settlement Although Guddavva's son and his wife took great care of her, She never sat idle but continued all types of productive work for the pleasure and benefit of the Children in the family.

The story is named "The Moon in the Earthen Pot" because Guddavva used to tell stories to the Children at bed time in the evening. Her favourite story was connected with Moon as Children were astonished and happy with the Moon light. On an evening, the Children wanted the Moon and Guddavva agreed to give them the moon. During day time, when the Children asked for the moon, she said that it was preserved inside the earthen Pot.

4. Comment on the moment of transformation of the thief in Ruskin Bond's short story 'The Thief'. [WBUT 2014]

Answer:

First, we have the author, Ruskin's intent in this novel is to highlight the significance of trust in human relationships. Our story's narrator is a thief. He is manipulative and deceitful. When he introduces himself to Arun, he says his name is Deepak (the first lie), and then he asks for a job. Arun gives him a job as a cook (our narrator can't cook), but tells him that he hasn't any money to pay him so he'll give room and board in exchange for his services. This of course is acceptable because Deepak doesn't want a job, he wants to rob him.

When Arun find out that he's a terrible cook, Deepak talks him into keeping him anyway. Arun then teaches him not only how to cook, but how to read, write, and count money as well. Deepak watches Arun hide money under the mattress, and Arun even goes so far as to give him a key.

Suddenly, Deepak undergoes a change, he can't make up his mind whether he still wants to rob Arun. One of his given reasons, "He was the most trusting person I'd ever met."

But on the other hand, Deepak also thought up all of the reason he should rob Arun;

- he's out of practice (thieving)
- if he doesn't take the money, Arun will just spend it on someone else
- he deserves it because he doesn't get paid (he forgets the food and

Well, after looking at the pros and cons; Deepak chooses to steal some of the money that Arun has hidden away and catch a train to get out of town--- he actually pulls it off, but

just when he was supposed to get on the train, he lets it leave without him and while trying to figure out what to do next starts thinking again:

- he misses Arun
- he misses conversation
- he wants to learn to write in whole sentences

Suddenly, the friendship becomes more important than the money; Arun's trust is more important than anything he can steal; learning a new craft is more important than practicing the old (thieving).

He goes back to Arun's, replaces the money, and then admits to him what he has done. Then he realizes that Arun has known all along, that the money he replaced was wet from the rain the night before. Arun doesn't question him, but he lets him know he knows. In the end, the trust of Arun changes the narrator's life. Something as simple as trust can change the world.

5. Do you feel that the attitude towards love and marriage has undergone any change with the change of time? Justify your points making a comparative study with "Marriage is a Private Affair". [WBUT 2016]

Answer:

There have been many controversies about marriage and its traditions. Our world is changing and people are learning about different cultures and freedoms. Many cultures have arranged marriages but nowadays marriage is becoming more of the individual's choice in whom they marry. This change in tradition causes many conflicts within the family as well as the culture group and raises questions of tradition and independence. To some it's a choice, but to others it's a tradition.

Marriage is a very beautiful and important part of our lives. When two people decide to spend their lives together, getting married is the final step. We live in the 21st century. However, in some parts of the world, who you will get married to still depends on your parents' decision. This terrible aspect of young peoples' lives is shown in the story "Marriage is a private affair" by Chinua Achebe. Old traditions, conflict between generations, and love that stands over an argument in Achebe's story.

The story, "Marriage is a private affair", takes place in a tribe in Nigeria. The main characters are Nnaemeka the son, Nene the girlfriend and soon to be wife, Ugoye the girl chosen by the father to marry his son and of course the father Okeke. Nnaemeka is deeply in love with Nene and have plans to marry her but his father has no idea about this. Nene lives in the Lagos the city in South Western Nigeria. Soon after Okeke Nnaemeka receives a letter from his father stating that he has arranged his marriage with Ugoye, a girl from their tribe who in his opinion has all the qualification to become a great wife. With this news Nnaemeka is torn apart because he loves Nene but has to face his father with the decision that he will not obey him on this marriage he has planned. Nnaemeka keeps that information away from Nene and heads to his tribe to have his conversation he has not been looking forward to. When he finally has the conversation, it escalates to a verbal argument for he tells his father about Nene and that she is the only girl he will marry, even if it goes against him. Okeke is upset and does not want anything to do with Nene or him for he will not bless this marriage. He then goes on telling Nene all that has

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happened but besides the opposing conflict on their marriage they still get married and form a family have two sons. All this time his father has isolated himself from them. After some time Nene's sons are intrigued to meet their grandfather. So she sends Okeke a letter letting him know about his grandsons and how they want to meet him. This letter makes him very emotional and he can no longer hold his emotions in and realizes family ties are hard to let go. He wants to meet his family for they are his family and this dispute has gone too long and has only wasted time.

The advantages and disadvantages of love and arranged marriages are:

Love marriage:

- Both individuals know each other already and mutually decide to spend the whole life with each other.
- Couple is responsible for its choice and onus of the blame in future lies on the couple only and nobody else.
- Couple is aware of each other's likes and dislikes. Therefore they will get along well.
- Couple can eradicate social evil like dowry with their mutual consent because they have the independence to take such decisions at their own level.
- The culture of the extravagant spending too can be curbed by the understanding between the couple.

Love marriage is better when two individuals know each other in their true sense instead of projecting only their positives. Understanding each other well will be the basic victory. But when our mind is attracted towards someone, we do tend to show all our good notes to get the person's attention. That is why many love marriages end up in vain.

Arranged marriage:

- Arrange Marriage is not a contract between two individuals alone but a confluence of two families.
- Two families involved in arrange marriages know each other very well and are compatible with each other.
- Because there are more people involved in arrange marriage, the conflict between the couple will be effectively resolved or mitigated.
- Couple is guided by parents experience whereas in love marriage couple is unknown about the future complexities in life and lacks this experience.

In an arranged marriage, the couples make up their mind to compromise a bit. With changing trends, even that has evolved and couples take time between engagement and marriage to know and understand each other better.

Conclusion:

Both ways have their merits as well as demerits and marriage is a decision of lifetime. Though families are involved in most of the marriages, it's the couple which has to live together for lifetime. At the end of the day "marriage is a private affair" and is to be decided by and restricted largely between the couple. With changing times, the newer generation has become far more flexible about their partners and is willing to take risks. The opinion of the older generation is no longer as rigidly heeded as before. The older generation is mostly forced to accept the decisions and choices made by their children.

WRITING PRACTICES

Very Short Answer Type Questions

1. Which one should be used while writing a Precis? [WBUT 2008]
 a) Redundancy b) Wordiness c) Passive voice d) Conciseness
 Answer: (d)

2. Give four examples of Expository writing. [WBUT 2023]
 Answer: essays, textbooks, instructional guides and news reports

3. What is a business letter? [WBUT 2023]
 Answer:

A business letter is a professional, formal letter that is sent by one company to another. These letters can be used for professional correspondence between business clients, employees, stakeholders as well as individuals.

Short Answer Type Questions

1. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow: [WBUT 2019]
 What needs to be set right is our approach to work. It is a common sight in our country of employees reporting for duty on time and at the same time doing little work. If an assessment is made of time they spent in gossiping, drinking tea, eating 'pan' and smoking cigarettes, it will be shocking to know that the time devoted to actual work is negligible. The problem is the standard which the leadership in administration sets for the staff. Forget the ministers because, they mix politics and administration. What do top bureaucrats do? What do the below down officials do? The administration set up remains weak mainly because the employees do not have the right example to follow and they are more concerned about being in the good books of the bosses than doing work.
- a) The employees in our country
 i) are quite punctual but not duty conscious
 ii) are not punctual, but somehow manage to complete their work
 iii) are somewhat lazy but good natured
 iv) are not very highly qualified.
- b) According to the writer, the administration in India
 i) is by and large effective
 ii) is very strict and firm
 iii) is affected by red tape
 iv) is more or less ineffective.
- c) The word 'assessment' means
 i) enquiry
 ii) report
 iii) evaluation

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iv) summary

- d) The leadership in administration
- i) sets a fine example to the employees
 - ii) is of a reasonably high standard
 - iii) is composed of idealists
 - iv) is of a very poor standard.
- e) The central idea of the passage could be best expressed as
- i) the employee's outlook towards work is justified
 - ii) the employee must change their outlook towards work
 - iii) the employees would never change their work culture
 - iv) the employer-employee relationship is far from healthy.

Answer:

- a) are quite punctual but not duty conscious
- b) is more or less ineffective
- c) evaluation
- d) is of a very poor standard
- e) the employer-employee relationship is far from healthy

Long Answer Type Questions

1. Read the following passage and answer the questions in your own words:

[WBUT 2010, 2013]

Bangalore: India said on Saturday the 'protectionist tendency' in the United States would deepen the global recession and delay global economic recovery. "I feel the protectionism tendency is healthy and negative and lessons from the past make it abundantly clear they end up deepening the recession, they do not help in recovery of economies," Union Commerce and Industry Minister Anand Sharma told reporters here. Sharma was referring to the State of Ohio's ban on outsourcing to overseas companies and before that, the US Government's decision to raise fees for H1B visas that would impact operations of the \$50 billion Indian IT industry.

US President Barack Obama also said this week he would end tax breaks for companies which 'creates jobs and profits in other countries'. Admitting that India does not have legal options against such US measures, he said the larger issue was of "approach and philosophy". "Any mindset which is isolatory and inward looking ends up hurting the economies and societies", Sharma said.

Sharma termed the 'protectionist' measures in the US as "regressive and counter-productive". "As a leading economy of the world, the US has to have more confidence to engage the rest of the world. In my view, in testing times, it's important to step out and engage, to dismantle the existing barriers and not erect new ones," Sharma said.

Stating that the US was strategic partner of India, he said New Delhi wants to deepen and diversify bi-lateral engagement. "We have to positively contribute for the growth of our relationship and not undermine or weaken it in any manner."

(The Times of India, September 12, 2010)

i) What is India's stand on the "protectionist tendency" of the US?

Answer:

India's stand on the "protectionist tendency" of the US is that it would deepen the global recession and delay global economic recovery. It is healthy and negative and lessons from the past make it abundantly clear that it ends up deepening the recession not helping in recovery of economics.

ii) What step of the State of Ohio has displeased India?

Answer:

The step of the State of Ohio's ban on outsourcing to overseas companies has displeased India.

iii) What is Mr. Obama's important announcement this week?

Answer:

Mr. Obama's important announcement this week was that he would end tax breaks for companies which "creates jobs and profits in other countries".

iv) How has Mr. Sharma termed the "protectionist" measure of the US?

Answer:

Mr. Sharma termed the "protectionist" measure of the US, "that any mind set, which is isolatory and inward looking ends up hurting the economics and societies. It is regressive and counter-productive "None has any legal options against such US measures.

v) What is Mr. Sharma's expectation from the US as a leading economy of the World?

Answer:

Mr. Sharma's expectations from the US as a leading economy of the world is its "approach and philosophy". US has to have more confidence to step out and engage the rest of the world, to dismantle the existing barrier, avoid erecting new ones.

vi) Make a précis of the given passage.

Answer:

The union Commerce and Industry Minister of India, Mr. Anand Sharma said to the reporter that the protectionist measure of the US would deepen global recession and delay global economic recovery. The ban on outsourcing to overseas companies by the state of Ohio and the US Govt. decision to raise fees for H1B visas would have an impact on operations of the \$50 billion Indian IT Industry.

US President Barack Obamas announced ending tax breaks for companies which creates jobs and profits in other countries. Sharma said, it hurts the economics and societies as it is isolatory and inward looking. India does not have legal options against such US measures as because the issue was of "approach and philosophy".

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Sharma termed the protectionist measures in the US as “regressive and counter-productive”. Being a leading economy of the world, the US has to have more confidence in engaging the rest of the world, dismantle existing barriers not erect new ones.

India being a strategic partner to US, New Delhi wants to deepen and diversify bi-lateral engagement and positively contribute for the growth of relationship and not undermine or weaken it in any manner.

2. Read the following passage and then answer the questions in your words.

[WBUT 2011]

As Nnaemeka walked home that evening he turned over in his mind different ways of overcoming his father's opposition, especially now that his father had gone and found a girl for him. He had thought of showing his letter to Nene but decided on second thoughts not to, at least for the moment. He read it again when he got home and couldn't help smiling to himself. He remembered Ugoye quite well; an Amazon of a girl who used to beat all the boys, himself included, on the way to the stream, a complete dunce at school. 'I have found a girl who will suit you admirably – Ugoye Nweke, the eldest daughter of our neighbor, Jacob Nweke. She has a proper Christian upbringing. When she stopped schooling some years ago, her father (a man of sound judgement) sent her to live in the house of a pastor where she has received all the training a good wife could need. Her Sunday school teacher has told me that she reads her Bible very fluently. I hope we shall begin negotiations when you come home in December.'

On the second evening of his return from Lagos Nnaemeka sat with his father under a cassia tree. This was the old man's retreat when he went to read his Bible when the parching December sun had set and a fresh, reviving wind blew on the leaves.

'Father,' began Nnaemeka suddenly, 'I have come to ask for forgiveness'.

'Forgiveness? For what, my son?' he asked in amazement.

'It's about this marriage question?'

'Which marriage question?'

'I can't We must – I mean it is impossible for me to marry Nweke's daughter.'

'Impossible? Why?' asked his father.

'I don't love her.'

'Nobody said you did. Why should you?' he asked.

'Marriage today is different

a) What is the passage all about?

Answer:

The passage is about the contrasting views on the institution of marriage, that people from two different generations – a father and a son, possess. It also deals with the rigid norms, the members of the tribe had to follow.

b) Can you bring out the tension between the father and the son?

Answer:

From the very beginning of the passage, the tension between Nnaemeka and his father is made evident. The story begins with Nnaemeka trying hard to find ways of overcoming his father's opposition. Also, one can easily make out the fear in his tone, while he tells his father that he cannot marry Ugoye Nweke.

c) Why does Nnaemeka not want to marry Ugoye Nweke? Explain this with reference to the statement 'Marriage today is different...'

Answer:

Nnaemeka never loved Ugoye, and love to him is the most important aspect of a marriage. Ugoye, used to be an Amazon of a girl, who used to bully the boys, but a complete dunce at school. Moreover, Nnaemeka loved Nene and intended to marry her.

d) How is Nnaemeka's father's description of Ugoye's character different from Nnaemeka?

Answer:

Nnaemeka's memories of Ugoye Nweke was not quite a pleasant one. She used to beat all the boys on the way to the stream. His father however, thought differently of her. According to him, Ugoye would make a good wife as she had been trained to be so by the pastor. Also, that she is a regular with her bible.

e) Can you guess the title and author of the story?

Answer:

The story is Marriage is a Private Affair by Nigerian writer Chinua Achebe.

f) Write a précis from the given passage giving it a suitable title.

Answer:

Love and Marriage

Nnaemeka loved Nene, but he was sure of the fact that his father would never accept her. He had found a girl for Nnaemeka to marry, the eldest daughter of their neighbour Jacobe Nweke, Ugoye. He remembered how Ugoye used to bully the boys, including him, on the way to the stream. Nnaemeka's father believed that she would make a good wife, as she had been trained by a pastor to do so. Also, she had a proper Christian upbringing. Nnaemeka did not love Ugoye and finally on the second evening of his return from Lagos, he told him so. He asked for forgiveness from his father and told him that marriage in today's times is based on love.

3. Read the following passage and then answer the questions in your own words: [WBUT 2012]

These natural jobs cannot be shirked. But they involve other jobs which can. As we must eat we must first provide food, as we must sleep we must have beds and bedding in houses with fireplaces and coals, as we must walk through the streets we must have clothes to cover our nakedness. Now food and houses and clothes can be produced by human labour. But when they are produced they can be stolen. If you like honey you can let the bees produce it by their labour, and then steal it from them. If you are too lazy to get about from place to place on your own legs you can make a slave of a horse. And what you do to a horse or a bee you can also do to a man or a woman or a child if you can get the upper hand of them by force or fraud or trickery of any sort, or even by teaching them that it is their religious duty to sacrifice their freedom to yours. So beware! If you allow any person, or class of persons, to get the upper hand of you, they will shift all that part of their slavery to Nature that can be shifted on to your shoulders, and you will find yourself working from eight to fourteen hours a day when, if

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you had only yourself and your family to provide for, you could do it quite comfortably in half the time or less. The object of all honest governments should be to prevent your being imposed on in this way. But the object of most actual governments is exactly the opposite. They enforce your slavery and call it freedom. But they also regulate your slavery, keeping the greed of your masters within certain bounds. When chattel slavery of the Negro sort costs more than wage slavery, they abolish chattel slavery and make you free to choose between one employment, or one master, and another, and this they call a glorious triumph for freedom, though for you it is merely the key of the street. When you complain, they promise that in future you shall govern the country for yourself. They redeem this promise by giving you a vote, and having a general election every five years or so. At the election, two of their rich friends ask for your vote, and you are free to choose which of them you will vote for the spite the other, a choice which leaves you no freer than you were before, as it does not reduce your hours of labour by a single minute. But the newspapers assure you that your vote has decided the election, and that this constitutes you a free citizen in a democratic country. The amazing thing about it is that you are fool enough to believe them.

a) How does nature stop man from being totally free?

Answer:

Men work hard and build infrastructure to become free from nature and improve living condition. However, some time nature suddenly destroys such man made facilities and makes human being again dependent upon nature.

b) What according to the author is the difference between natural slavery and un-natural slavery?

Answer:

According to the Author actions required for providing food, clothes and shelter are natural slavery. Shifting of natural slavery of individual or group of individuals for their benefit on other human by force or fraud or trickery is un-natural slavery.

c) In what ways the master-classes prevent common people from realizing their slavery?

Answer:

The master classes enforce slavery on common persons by force or fraud or trickery and call it freedom. This freedom for common man prevents them from realizing the slavery.

d) Give your opinion regarding the author's views on Parliamentary Government.

Answer:

The Author opined that in the Present form of Parliamentary democracy all the candidates opting for election aim at making general public to accept slavery. This style of election does not really aim at welfare of general masses.

e) Give the meaning of the word 'shirked' as used in the passage and make a sentence with it.

Answer:

"Shirked" refers to passing of the work to others.

The Politicians have shirked responsibilities of maintaining good governance on local goons.

f) Write a précis of the given passage and add a suitable title to it.

Answer:

MOCKERY OF DEMOCRACY

In the name of democracy, a few people form political parties in different names and style. But aim of all these people/ group of people is to remain in power either by brute force or fraud or trickery and make general public to work more or to do slavery for contributing to the benefits of such power hungry politicians.

4. Read the text below and answer the following questions: [WBUT 2012]

India has the highest number of malnourished children in the world, with Madhya Pradesh being the worst-affected state.

About 47% of children under five in the country, totaling 57 million, are underweight. Even sub-Saharan Africa is better off, with 33% of children malnourished. These shocking figures have been mentioned in UNICEF's PROGRESS FOR CHILDREN: A report Card no Nutrition released globally on Tuesday. The other badly affected states in India are Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Orissa, Bihar and Maharashtra. Over 50% children in some of these states are malnourished. However, some Indian states have better report cards. Malnourishments among children is significantly low in Goa, Kerala, Mizoram and Tamil Nadu.

According to Dr. Werner Schultink, UNICEF India's chief of child development and nutrition programme, the causes for this malnutrition are many: bad quality feeding, high population density, high rate of illiteracy among women, gender inequality, low rate of immunization and high rate of birth of underweight bodies.

a) Complete the following with information from the text given:

- i) The number of malnourished children under five in India is
- ii) The states in India which have a high percentage of malnourished children are -
- iii) A comparatively good record of well-nourished children is to be found in
- iv) Dr. Werner Schultink is

Answer:

- i) 47%
- ii) Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Orissa, Bihar and Maharashtra
- iii) Goa, Kerala, Mizoram and Tamil Nadu
- iv) UNICEF India's Chief of Child Development and Nutrition Programme

b) List six reasons for the malnourishment of children.

Answer:

- i) bad quality feeding
- ii) high population density
- iii) high rate of illiteracy among women
- iv) gender inequality

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- v) low rate of immunization
- vi) high rate of birth of underweight bodies

c) Write a précis of the given passage and add a title to it.

Answer:

MALNUTRITION OF INDIAN CHILDREN

It was observed that about 47% of Indian children fewer than 5 years of age totaling around 57 Millions are malnourished and are birth underweight, in a recent study by the UNICEF. Now a days this is highest rate of child malnutrition in the world. Indian states like - Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Orissa, Bihar and Maharashtra are most affected. But malnutrition amongst children was found insignificant in Indian states like Goa, Kerala, Mizoram and Tamil Nadu.

As per The UNICEF report, the main cause for malnutrition was bad quality feeding, high population density, high rate of illiteracy among women, gender inequality, low rate of immunization and high rate of birth of underweight babies.

5. Write an essay in around 300 words on the following topics:

a) The technological miracles of the 21st century

[WBUT 2014]

Answer:

Technological miracles of the 21st century

Some of the technological miracles of the 21st century includes:

Storage mediums like DVD, Blu-ray technology, Compact Disc and online streaming, High Definition Television replacing Standard definition.

The World Wide Web and websites becomes a major new medium for storing files and information. Introduction of smart phones and tablets with 3G and 4G helps connect mobile devices to the internet. These gradually start to replace desktop and laptop computers in the early and mid 2010s. By the 2010s, the majority of people in the developed world had Internet access and the majority of people worldwide had a mobile phone.

The first and largest video-sharing site on the Internet is YouTube, invented in 2005 by Steve Chen, Chad Hurley and Jawed Karim. YouTube has revolutionized media by allowing anybody with a video camera to create a video and show it to the rest of the world. It is used by people to sell their services, build music careers, comment on politics and many other things.

The iPod was invented by Tony Fadell, who was hired by Apple in early 2001. The iPod will play thousands of audio files from a small hard disc it uses to store music files. Social networking has become one of the top uses of the Internet along with search engine queries.

Facebook is by far the most successful social network, connecting people with others online so they can share information and communicate with each other. Facebook was founded in 2003 by Mark Zuckerberg and his Harvard roommates Chris Hughes, Eduardo Saverin and Dustin Moskovitz

In 2007 David Gow invented the iLIMB, the first artificial hand with five individually powered fingers. This breakthrough allows people to grip oddly shaped objects like balls

and coffee mug handles. Gow persisted through the many technological hurdles and created the iLIMB with three separate parts: the finger, thumb and palm. Each part is equipped with its own motor-control system.

We are on the threshold of being able to program our own DNA, but that is the next step in human evolution. By the end of the century, parents will be able to determine the sex, intelligence, and even hair and eye color of their child while turning off any possibly dangerous genetic defects their offspring might have been in line to inherit.

As such, it is likely that before the dawn of the next century people will be able to fly between London and Tokyo at Mach 10 speeds and arrive at their destination in just over two hours. It is said that by the end of the 19th century, the fastest a man could travel on a regular basis was 60 mph (by train). By the end of the 20th century, that speed had increased ten-fold, to 600 mph.

Some of these above advances forces us to believe that life is moving at a very fast pace, and technology is soon to empower and infringe every aspect of the human society as such.

b) Time as a tyrant of modern life

[WBUT 2014]

Answer:

Time as a tyrant of modern life

Time constraints make it impossible to do everything...

Our lives are temporal. Time passes, and with that our lives. Dissolving into things, processes, and events as the mode of their becoming, time is a medium within which every being is able to exist and develop. Time is, however, also destructive. Its power means that everything, including ourselves, is transient, provisional and bound to come to an irreversible end.

At least since the introduction of the pocket watch in the 16th century brought exact time measurement into everyday life, modern agents have found themselves increasingly encased in a calculable and measurable temporal environment. We measure and organize time as never before, and we worry about not "losing" or "wasting" time, as though time was a finite substance or a container into which we should try to stuff as many good experiences as possible.

Clock time is the time of our modern, busy and highly coordinated and interconnected lives. It is the time of planning and control, of setting goals and achieving them in the most efficient manner. We move through such time in the same way we drive a car: calculating the distance passed while coordinating our movement with that of other drivers, passing through an environment that can never be particularly significant and which will soon be observable in the mirror.

Modern society is unimaginable without clock time. With the rise of the chronometer came a vast increase in discipline, efficiency and social speed, transforming every institution and human endeavor. The factory, the office, transportation, business, the flow of information, indeed almost everything we do and relate to is to a greater or lesser extent controlled by the clock.

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When the observation of natural cycles played a greater role in people's awareness of temporality, change was "softer," less precisely calculable, and intimately tied to a more fluid and large-scale sense of rhythm.

Despite our increasing reliance on the mechanical measurement of time to structure our lives, many of us find some part of us resisting it. We find it confining, too rigid perhaps to suit our natural states, and long for that looser structure of the medieval village.

What is behind this resistance? The modern time frame brings about two fundamental forms of dissatisfaction. For one thing, it exacerbates and intensifies our sense of transience. If time is understood as a succession of discrete moments, then, strictly speaking, our experience will be one of perpetual loss: every instant, every unit of time, is a mere passing from that which has not yet been to that which will never again be, and the passing itself will not endure but simply be a boundary between future and present. "In time," the philosopher Schopenhauer put it, "each moment is, only in so far as it has effaced its father the preceding moment, to be again effaced just as quickly itself. Past and future are as empty and unreal as any dream."

c) Is attainment of peace the ultimate goal of life?

[WBUT 2014]

Answer:

Is attainment of peace the ultimate goal of life?

The term 'peace' originates most recently from the Anglo-French *paix*, and the Old French *paiz*, meaning "peace, reconciliation, silence, agreement". Peace is an occurrence of harmony characterized by lack of violence, conflict behaviors and the freedom from fear of violence. Commonly understood as the absence of hostility and retribution, peace also suggests sincere attempts at reconciliation, the existence of healthy or newly healed interpersonal or international relationships, prosperity in matters of social or economic welfare, the establishment of equality, and a working political order that serves the true interests of all. Inner peace (or peace of mind) refers to a state of being mentally and spiritually at peace, with enough knowledge and understanding to keep oneself strong in the face of discord or stress. Being "at peace" is considered by many to be healthy homeostasis and the opposite of being stressed or anxious. Peace of mind is generally associated with bliss and happiness.

You worry about a lot of things every day. Sometimes it is overwhelming but you cannot just abandon all the worry. Worrying a lot is not healthy. When you feel like you are going to burst, you wish that you can have the peace of mind like Buddha.

Humans are spiritual beings and the mind is our essence. Everything is subject to the cause of law and effect so when we change our thoughts and our state of mind, our human relationships, health and financial circumstances change too. The causes of pain and suffering do not lie with others or the outside world but are actually created by ourselves. Therefore, we need to reflect on our thoughts and deeds and correct them through our own effort.

The learning distilled from the experience of overcoming suffering becomes "wisdom." Increased enlightenment is actually the purpose of life. Knowing that "life is a workbook" is the first step towards enlightenment as we can understand that the

difficulties and hardships of this world are not substantial but are opportunities for our personal growth.

Confrontation with difficulties and hardships are opportunities for learning. Suffering is an opportunity to reflect on the mistakes of our own mind and to reform ourselves. At such times it is important to have knowledge of the Truth – the teachings which represent God's (Buddha's) mind, and to practice self-reflection. The scriptures of God's (Buddha's) Truth are reference books given to us by God (Buddha) for solving "the workbook known as life.

Only when one is at peace with oneself can one be at peace with the world at large. If every individual can manage to reach this state of bliss, the world will be without conflicts of any kind. The ultimate goal therefore is to find peace in one's life under every circumstance.

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

[WBUT 2014]

The function of the universities is not merely to send out technically skilled and professionally competent men, but it is their duty to produce in them the quality of compassion. The quality which enables the individuals to treat one another in a truly democratic spirit. Our religions have proclaimed from the very beginning that each human individual is to be regarded as a spark of the divine. Tat twam asi, that art thou, is the teaching of the "Upanishads". The Buddhists declared that each individual has in him a spark of the divine and can become a Bodhisattva. These proclamations by themselves are not enough. The minds and hearts of the people require to be attended. We must strike too become democratic not merely in the political sense of the term but also in the social and economic sense. It is essential to bring about this democratic change, this democratic temper, the kind of outlook by a proper study of the humanities, including philosophy and religion. There is a great verse which says that in this poison-tree of Samsara are two fruits of incomparable value. They are the enjoyment of great books and the company of good souls. If we want to absorb the fruits of a great literature, we read them, not as we do cricket stories but read them with concentration. Our generations in its rapid travel has not achieved that habit of reading the great classics of our country. If these principles of democracy in our Construction are to become habits of mind and pattern of behaviour, principles which change the very character of the individual and the nature of the society it can be done only by the study of great literature, of philosophy and religion. That is, even though our country needs great scientists, great technologists, great engineers, we should not neglect to make them humanists. While we retain science and technology, we remember that science and technology are not all.

a) What, according to the author, is the duty of universities?

Answer:

According to the author, the duty of the universities is to instil in them the quality of compassion among the skilled and professionally competent men that they are producing.

b) How is compassion defined?

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Answer:

Compassion is defined as the quality in men which enables them to treat one another in a truly democratic spirit.

c) Why is proper study of the humanities essential?

Answer:

Proper study of humanities enables men to bring about a democratic temper, a kind of outlook which can enable men to become democratic in the social and economic sense.

d) What does the study of great literature achieve for us?

Answer:

The study of great literature will allow individuals to be influenced by great people and their principles of democracy can then penetrate the minds and help in the construction of patterns of behaviour, and habits of the mind.

e) Explain any two of the following in your own words:

i) Truly democratic spirit

ii) Cricket stories

iii) Humanities

Answer:

i) Truly democratic spirit:

By referring to a truly democratic spirit, we refer to a spirit which believes in political or social equality and which does not distinguish the common people from any privileged class. They treat the common people with respect to their political power. A Democratic Spirit is one that combines rigor and humility, i.e., passionate conviction plus a sedulous respect for the convictions of others. Democratic Spirit's constituent rigor and humility and self-honesty are, in fact, so hard to maintain on certain issues that it's almost irresistibly tempting to fall in with some established dogmatic camp.

ii) Cricket stories:

Cricket stories collectively refer to a genre of stories which make up a light read. It does not force the reader to engage himself intellectually or analytically to spend time mulling over it or analyzing the details. Unlike some great classics or philosophical books, these are filled with anecdotes and snippets which are basically events of the past. These neither allow us to dwell in the moment nor to predict the future. Therefore they engage very little of our mindspace.

iii) Humanities:

Humanist may refer to a proponent or practitioner of humanism, which has several distinct senses. Humanism is a philosophical and ethical stance that emphasizes the value and agency of human beings, individually and collectively, and generally prefers critical thinking and evidence (rationalism, empiricism) over established doctrine or faith (fideism). The meaning of the term humanism has fluctuated, according to the successive

intellectual movements which have identified with it. Generally, however, humanism refers to a perspective that affirms some notion of a "human nature".

f) Make precis of the passage given above and give a suitable title.

Answer:

The importance of humanities

Universities should increasingly involve themselves in instilling in skilled and competent men the outlook and quality of socially and economic democracy. Our Upanishads teach us that each individual can become a Bodhisattva as they are born with a spark of the divine. They should be encouraged to nurture greater values through association of great books and great souls. These will help to influence them in the construction of good habits and principles that will change the nature of the society. Reading books will help instill human values for it is as essential as science and technology.

7. Write an essay in around 300 words on the following topics:

a) Electronic Gadgets in Our Everyday Lives.

[WBUT 2015]

Answer:

Electronic Gadgets in Our Everyday Lives

The placid, laid-back lifestyle of yesteryear is gone and passed. Today's society focuses on doing as much as you can in the little amount of time the day allots you. Technology, gadgets, and electronics run our everyday lives. Most people wouldn't know what to do if they didn't have smart phones to check their e-mails at any time and any place, nor would they be able to keep connected to family and friends. Laptops, iPods, netbooks, and cell phones are luxuries we use every single day. As we wake up every weekday morning, it is usually to the beeping of an alarm clock. While you get ready for work, you may flip on the television to check out the morning's news, or turn on the radio to listen to your favorite tunes while you get dressed and ready. An individual uses a number of different electronics and gadgets that just made your morning go smoother and easier. Most individuals understand the importance of gadgets and electronics in our everyday life, but most don't realize the scope at which it reaches. Technology affects all aspects of our lives. Without advancements in the medical field and electronics provided by doctors' offices and hospitals, our life expectancy would not be near what it is today. MRI machines, many lifesaving invasive surgeries, and a number of preventative procedures would not be available if it was not for advancements in gadgets and electronics. Whether it's the GPS you use to get to unfamiliar destinations, or the iPod you use to listen to your favorite music while working out, or even the wine refrigerator you use to store your amazing wine collection at the perfect temperature, these gadgets and electronics improve our quality of life to its highest extent making everyday living easy, convenient, and fun.

[WBUT 2015]

b) Efficacy of "Clean India" campaign

Answer:

Efficacy of “Clean India” campaign

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan is also called as the Clean India Mission or Clean India drive. It is a national level campaign run by the Indian Government to cover all the backward statutory towns to make them clean. This campaign involves the construction of latrines, promoting sanitation programmes in the rural areas, cleaning streets, roads and changing the infrastructure of the country to lead the country ahead. This campaign was officially launched by the Prime Minister, Narendra Modi on 145th birth anniversary of the Mahatma Gandhi on 2nd of October in 2014.

Between April 2014 and January 2015, 31.83 lakh toilets were built. Karnataka led all States in construction of toilets under the programme, while Punjab built the least. As of August 2015, 80 lakh toilets have been constructed under the program. As of 18 March 2016, 10 districts in India were ODF.

Both private companies as well as government have started releasing progress reports. Swachh Bharat app Tumble feed provides updates from Individual groups, corporates and Twitter users in general about group cleaning events, status of cleanliness across India and opinions on the objectives of Clean India mission. A recent study by Public Affairs Centre finds that participation of beneficiaries in their toilet construction ensures better usage. To give a fillip to the Total Sanitation Campaign, effective June 2003 the government launched an incentive scheme in the form of an award for total sanitation coverage, maintenance of a clean environment and open defecation-free panchayat villages, blocks and districts called Nirmal Gram Puraskar.

It is launched as a responsibility of the each and every Indian citizen to make this country a Swachh country. This campaign has initiated people globally towards the cleanliness. Teachers and students of the school are joining this “Clean India Campaign” very actively with great favour and joy.

c) The Uses of Paper

[WBUT 2015]

Answer:

Though the invention of paper in China would seem to have heralded the invention of paperwork, the Chinese bureaucracy was already hard at work, covering thousands and thousands of bamboo slips with accounts, reports, audits and diaries, by the time that paper first appeared in the early Han dynasty. Paper quickly became the ideal medium for bureaucratic paperwork.

Paper is a thin material produced by pressing together moist fibres of cellulose pulp derived from wood, rags or grasses, and drying them into flexible sheets. It is a versatile material with many uses, including writing, printing, packaging, cleaning, and a number of industrial and construction processes. Paper can be produced with a wide variety of properties, depending on its intended use. Some of its uses are:

- **For representing value:** paper money, bank note, cheque, security (see *security paper*), voucher and ticket.
- **For storing information:** book, notebook, magazine, newspaper, art, zine, letter
- **For personal use:** diary, note to remind oneself, etc.; for temporary personal use: scratch paper.

- **For communication:** between individuals and/or groups of people.
- **For packaging:** corrugated box, paper bag, envelope, Packing & Wrapping Paper, Paper string, Charta emporetica and wallpaper.
- **For cleaning:** toilet paper, handkerchiefs, paper towels, facial tissue and cat litter.
- **For construction:** papier-mâché, origami, paper planes, quilling, paper honeycomb, used as a core material in composite materials, paper engineering, construction paper and paper clothing.
- **For other uses:** emery paper, sandpaper, blotting paper, litmus paper, universal indicator paper, paper chromatography, electrical insulation paper (see also *dielectric* and *permittivity*) and filter paper.
- **For Industrial use:** cable wrapping.
- **For Recreation and Miscellaneous:** balloon, board games, bumper stickers, cartridge shell greeting cards, gum & candy wrappers, jigsaw puzzles, kites, CD & audio tape inserts, coloring books, confetti.

8. Read the following passage carefully and answer the following questions in your words. [WBUT 2015]

If HD is today's revolution, 3D is going to be tomorrow's. There appear to be a slew of 3D products – 3D televisions, 3D monitors, 3D video games, 3D movies, 3D glasses and even 3D goggles that add a third dimension to games you play on your iPhone or iPod – slowly popping up on store shelves globally, though very few are visible in the Indian market yet. 3D TVs are leading the pack.

Today's 3D displays are mainly stereophonic models that alternately telecast images meant for the left and right eye stored in the even and odd fields, respectively, of the video signal. Or a shutter glass worn by the viewer alternately shuts off each eye, so that the eye sees only the video stream meant for it. The brain then follows its natural process of merging the two streams of data to present a 3D view to the user, just as it would merge the views of the right and left eye when we see a scene around us naturally.

While this was the basic technology behind 3D movies we saw decades ago, it has now come to our living rooms, thanks to the advanced display technology, lighter and stylish shutter glasses, and more capable broadcast techniques.

LED models, Plasma models, Special cameras for easy shooting of 3D content, real-time 2D-to-3D converters and more such technologies are coming up. Auto-stereoscopic models which do not require glasses are also expected in the future. In fact, mobile phone makers such as NTT Docomo, LG and HTC have already introduced devices that feature glassless 3D displays.

However, due to high price tags and insufficient content, 3D products are yet to catch up in India.

(Electronics For You, June 2011)

(a) Give example of 3D products which are slowly popping up globally. Which product is leading the pack?

Answer:

Examples of 3D products slowly popping up are 3D televisions, 3D monitors, 3D video games, 3D movies, 3D glasses, 3D goggles, etc. The one leading the group 3D TVs.

(b) What is the function of Shutter glasses?

Answer:

The Shutter glass worn by a viewer alternately shuts off each eye, so that the eye sees only the video stream meant for it.

(c) How does the brain present a 3D view to the user?

Answer:

The brain follows the natural process of merging the two streams of data from the left and right eye, as presented through the shutter glasses, to present a 3D view to the user just as it does naturally with images seen by the right and left eye.

(d) Mention the upcoming technologies in the field of 3D. What are Auto stereoscopic models?

Answer:

Some upcoming technologies are LED models, Plasma models, real time 2D to 3D converter, special cameras for easy shooting, etc. Auto-stereoscopic models do not require glasses.

(e) Mention the present status of 3D products in India.

Answer:

Mobile phone makers like NTT Docomo, LG and HTC have already introduced devices that feature glassless 3D displays. However, the high price tags and insufficient content prevents it from becoming popular yet.

(f) Write a précis of the given passage.

Answer:

A slew of 3D products are popping up in the market. 3D TVs are most available. The displays are mainly stereoscopic models that alternately telecast images from left and right eye or a shutter glass that alternately shuts off the two images. The brain then merges them through its natural process. This technology is now available because of lighter glasses, capable broadcasting techniques and advance displays. Some upcoming technologies are LED models, Plasma models, real time 2D to 3D converter, special cameras for easy shooting, etc. Auto-stereoscopic models are expected. Mobile phone makers like NTT Docomo, LG and HTC have introduced devices that feature glassless 3D displays which are yet to be popular in India.

9. Write an essay in around 300 words on the following topics:

a) Digital India: the need of the day

Answer:

[WBUT 2016]

Digital India: the need of the day

Digital India was launched by the Prime Minister of India Narendra Modi on 1 July 2015 with an objective of connecting rural areas with high-speed Internet networks and improving digital literacy. To be a part of the progressive world and keep up with the

fast-paced technologically, the nine pillars of growth areas which would be focused on are:

- **Broadband Highways** – High speed connectivity
- **Universal Access to Mobile Connectivity** – To reach inaccessible areas also.
- **Public Internet Access Programme** – Connect India to the world and newer ideas. It's a National Rural Internet Mission.
- **E-Governance** Improving governance using technology.
- **E-Kranti** – Deliver services electronically and thus in a faster and time bound manner. This is helpful in education, healthcare, planning, security, financial inclusion, justice, farmers, etc.
- **Information for all** - This will bring in transparency and accountability by easy and open access to documents and information to the citizens.
- **Electronics manufacturing** – This will encourage manufacturing of electronics in India and reduce electronics import and help in job creation too.
- **IT for jobs** – Employment opportunities will be increased as well as training aspect will be focused on under 'Skill India' program.
- **Early Harvest program** – This has a number of programs under it which are to be implemented within a short timeline. They addresses development in variety of sectors like education (school as well as university level), weather forecast, telecom, social problems like lost and found children, etc.

Impact of Digital India by 2019 which clearly justifies and necessitates the program:

- Broadband in 2.5 lakh villages, universal phone connectivity
- Net Zero Imports by 2020
- 400,000 Public Internet Access Points
- Wi-fi in 2.5 lakh schools, all universities; Public wi-fi hotspots for citizens
- Digital Inclusion: 1.7 Cr trained for IT, Telecom and Electronics Jobs
- Job creation: Direct 1.7 Cr. and Indirect at least 8.5 Cr.
- e-Governance & eServices: Across government
- India to be leader in IT use in services - health, education, banking
- Digitally empowered citizens - public cloud, internet access

b) The making of Smart Cities

[WBUT 2016]

Answer:

The making of Smart Cities

A **smart city** is an urban development vision to integrate information and communication technology (ICT) and Internet of things (IoT) technology in a secure fashion to manage a city's assets. ICT allows city officials to interact directly with the community and the city infrastructure and to monitor what is happening in the city and how to enable a better quality of life. Through the use of sensors integrated with real-time monitoring systems, data are collected from citizens and devices – then processed and analyzed. It has been suggested that a smart city uses information technologies to:

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1. Make more efficient use of physical infrastructure through artificial intelligence and data analytics
2. Engage effectively with local people in local governance and decision by use of open innovation processes and e-participation
3. Learn, adapt and innovate and thereby respond more effectively and promptly to changing circumstances

A smart city is all of the following:

- **Digital city:** It combines service oriented infrastructure, innovation services and communication infrastructure
- **Virtual city:** In these kinds of cities functions are implemented in a cyberspace
- **Information city:** It collects local information and delivers them to the public portal
- **Intelligent city:** It involves function as research or technological innovation to support learning and innovation procedure.
- **Ubiquitous city:** It creates an environment that connects citizens to any services through any device.
- **Creative city:** Creativity is recognized as a key driver to smart city and it represents also a version of it. Social infrastructures, like for instance intellectual and social capital are indispensable factors to build a city that is smart according to the human framework.
- **Learning city:** This type of city in the human context improves the competitiveness in the global knowledge economy.
- **Humane city:** It exploits human potential, in particular the knowledge workforce.
- **Knowledge city:** It is related to knowledge economy and innovation process

c) Terrorism is a menace to society

[WBUT 2016]

Answer:

Terrorism is a menace to society

Terrorism is one of gravest problems that society faces today. It has now become more lethal, widespread and difficult to control. Terrorism has its presence everywhere ranging from Indonesia, Malaysia to Sudan, Somalia, Egypt and Nigeria and Peru, Chile, America to Ireland. Terrorists are the greatest enemies of society because they undermine its stability by creating chaotic conditions leading to mass killing, damage and destruction. Generally, public places like airports, railway stations, etc. are their targets, but sometimes they shift their focus to some soft targets, like schools, hospitals, trains and buses where security is lax and security forces are not very vigilant. Terrorism is an unlawful use of violence aiming to inculcate fear among the masses. In modern times terrorism is being used to deliberately create communal tensions, and disrupt the peaceful atmosphere of a targeted society. Impact of terrorism has three motives-religious interests, ethnic minority interests and economic interests. But the real issue is the land, the power to hold it and to get maximum benefit from it. Terrorists groups today are well-equipped with state-of-the-art technologies. They are well armed with small, portable and easy-to-operate weapons. Indiscriminate firing, bombarding and hijacking are also used

by them as a tool to terrorise society. Terrorists today work under global network. Sometimes terrorists' activities are sponsored by bigger terrorist organisations. The causes of the emergence of terrorism can be found in socio-economic situations. Imbalance in growth and development, growing political unrest and dissatisfaction arising out of the government's policies or some other reasons, ill-treatment at home, etc., are some of the factors responsible for the birth of terrorism. The prevalence of corruption adds to the woes. In this age of Information Revolution, it is easier for the terrorist groups to spread their tentacles anywhere and everywhere. Ultimately whatever measures are taken, the conditions that give rise to terrorism should be tackled efficiently. Garnering public support to fight terrorism and creating awareness among people to be alert and vigilant about their surroundings is the key to thwarting terrorists.

10. Read the following passage carefully and answer the following questions in your words. [WBUT 2016]

The temperature of the Sun is over 5,000 degrees Fahrenheit at the surface, but it rises to perhaps more than 16 million degrees at the centre. The Sun is so much hotter than the Earth that matter can exist only as a gas, except at the core. In the core of the Sun, the pressures are so great against the gases that, despite the high temperature, there may be a small solid core. However, no one really knows, since the centre of the Sun can never be directly observed.

Solar astronomers do know that the Sun is divided into five layers or zones. Starting at the outside and going down into the Sun, the zones are the corona, chromospheres, photosphere, convection zone and finally the core. The first three zones are regarded as the Sun's atmosphere. But since the Sun has no solid surface, it is hard to tell where the atmosphere ends and the main body of the Sun begins.

The Sun's outermost layer begins about 10,000 miles above the visible surface and can be seen during an eclipse such as the one in February 1979 and goes outward for millions of miles.

The corona is a brilliant, pearly white, filmy light about as bright as the full Moon. Its beautiful rays are a sensational sight during an eclipse. The corona's rays flash out in a brilliant fan that has wispy spike-like rays near the Sun's north and south poles. The corona is thickest at the sun's equator.

The corona rays are made up of gases streaming outward at tremendous speeds and reaching a temperature of more than 2 million degrees Fahrenheit. The rays of gas thin out as they reach the space around the planets. By the time the Sun's corona rays reach the Earth, they are weak and invisible.

a) Why is there a small solid core in the sun?

Answer:

There is a small solid core in the sun because the pressure there is so great that the gases solidify despite the temperature.

b) How many zones in the sun divided into? Explain.

Answer:

The Sun is divided into five layers or zones. Starting at the outside and going down into the Sun, the zones are the corona, chromospheres, photosphere, convection zone and finally the core. The first three zones are regarded as the Sun's atmosphere.

c) Give a vivid description of the outer appearance of the corona.

Answer:

The corona is a brilliant, pearly white, filmy light about as bright as the full Moon. Its beautiful rays are a sensational sight during an eclipse. The corona's rays flash out in a brilliant fan that has wispy spike-like rays near the Sun's north and south poles. The corona is thickest at the sun's equator. The corona rays are made up of gases streaming outward at tremendous speeds and reaching a temperature of more than 2 million degrees Fahrenheit.

d) Why are the rays of the sun weak when they reach the Earth?

Answer:

The rays of gas emitted from the sun thin out as they reach the space around the planets. By the time the Sun's corona rays reach the Earth, they are weak and invisible.

e) The paragraphs following the passage most likely discuss which of the following?

- A) The remaining layers of the Sun form
- B) The evolution of the Sun to its present
- C) The eclipse of February 1979
- D) The scientists who study astronomy

Answer: (a)

f) Write a précis on the passage above and provide a suitable title.

Answer:

Sun - The Amazing Star

The temperature of the Sun is over 5,000 degrees Fahrenheit at the surface, and more than 16 million degrees at the centre. The Sun exists only as a gas, except at the solidified core due to intense pressure. The Sun is divided into five layers – the corona, chromospheres, photosphere, together called the atmosphere, and then the convection zone and core. The Sun's outermost layer begins about 10,000 miles above the visible surface. The corona is a brilliant white light as bright as the full Moon which can be seen during an eclipse. It's fan-like rays spike out near the Sun's north and south poles. The corona is thickest at the sun's equator. The corona rays are made up of gases streaming outward reaching a temperature of more than 2 million degrees Fahrenheit and thin out and weaken as they reach the Earth.

11. Write an essay in around 300 words on the following topics:

i) Murderous on line games

[WBUT 2017]

Answer:

Murderous on line games

Teenage online games are trending around the world. Online Games like Blue whale is causing anxiety among the parents. The sad part is that youths are unable to differentiate between online manipulation and real life. With the disturbing cases of teen suicides, the question is how to protect the youth? We must help kids engage in better activities like outdoor games or their stream of interest. One should communicate clearly about his/her well being. We must make some time and actively listen to the child. The best way to protect youths from the dangerous game is through web safety. It's always good to intervene and allow kids to express their feelings and concerns. Society needs to reduce the stigma of mental health issues, know how to interact with youth and act as a supporting mask. A bad academic performance or being treated badly can make them vulnerable to these games. One should support the other to overcome these habits and condemn them across the community. Social media sites need to have stricter laws in order to discourage such lethal games. The Blue Whale challenge instructs the participant to complete 50 tasks that include self-harm, watching scary videos, waking at odds hours, etc. As the game progresses with each task, the participant reaches the final day that culminates into suicide. In the Choking Game, teenagers deliberately begin choking themselves to achieve a euphoric high. In Salt and Ice, teenagers first put salt on their skin and then place ice over it under this challenge. The salt drastically reduces the temperature of the ice to as low as -26 degrees Celcius, causing horrific burns. In the Fire game, youngsters put themselves on fire, literally! They apply a flammable liquid to their naked torso and set it aflame. Directly playing with vulnerable kids, this game makes teenagers cut themselves on purpose, click pictures of the injuries, and upload these online.

b) Pleasures of reading

[WBUT 2017]

Answer:

Pleasures of reading

Food is necessary for our body. Similarly, we also need food for our mind. The best food for the mind is the reading of books. Reading gives us both pleasure and profit. Reading helps to enrich our knowledge. It amuses us as well. It is one of the best habits which remove the loneliness and boredom of life. It serves as a good companion in leisure. Reading makes us forget the cares and worries of life. It transports us to a world free from the cares and concerns of life. Reading is procreative and gives ennobling pleasure. Reading is of different kinds. It may be light or serious. It may be adventurous or spiritual. Every reading has its distinct pleasure. Some people like to read newspapers, periodicals, journals, etc. They are storehouse of general information about current events and various socio-political and economic problems. They offer us a peep into the world through which we can see the events taking place in various parts of the world. This type of reading is essential as they keep us well-informed. Many people seek delight in books on tour, travel and adventure. It takes us far away from the dull and dreary world. Reading of fiction and novel has its own distinct joy. He identifies himself with the characters in the novels which serves as a source of tremendous pleasure. Many people

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enjoy reading books on religion and philosophy. Such reading enriches the soul and enlightens the readers. Works of literature, philosophy and history make serious reading. Reading of these books gives an insight into our glorious past. We learn about the socio-culture and political life of contemporary society. Good books shape our thought and mould our characters. Besides being a source of pleasure, reading is a symbol of culture.

[WBUT 2017]

c) Leisure

Answer:

Leisure

Leisure means the free time at one's disposal. In fact, leisure time is the time when a man is his own master and is at liberty to pass his time in the manner he chooses. It gives a man an opportunity to engage in various leisure activities for enjoyment. There is a proverb, 'All work and no play makes Jack a dull boy'. This is quite true. Constant work brings fatigue to a man. Leisure gives our muscles and nerves rest. It releases a man from the monotony of toil and the worries of duty. And thus it gives him new vigor and energy. As a machine needs rest and oiling, so it is for a human body. Without leisure, human life would have been a dull affair. Aristotle said that leisure is an essential condition of happiness. It has been rightly described as the mother of art, science, philosophy and culture, as leisure time provides us time for deep thought and meditation. Of course, leisure time should be properly used. It should not be wasted away in idleness. There are various ways of spending one's leisure time through various leisure activities. Some go out to the countryside or some places of interest and feed their senses with sweet sights and hobbies that fill their leisure with pleasure. Utilizing leisure in a right way is really an art. It gives us an opportunity to acquire culture, to make and contemplate beautiful things. It offers an opportunity for aesthetic human relationships, for happiness and contentment, for sharing of the healthful and psychological values of friendship. In the leisure time we can think about the various creative works. However, we see that leisure is often abused. Many spend it in idle gossips over trifle matters. Some others waste their leisure time by drinking, gambling etc. We must pass our leisure time in a creative way. It is the only way to get pleasure in true sense.

12. Read the following passage carefully and answer the following questions in your words.

[WBUT 2017]

Kalpana Chawla, an aerospace engineer has become the first Indo-American woman to venture into space. It is a notable achievement for a lady from a male-dominated India. Kalpana, who is a naturalized US citizen, was born in Karnal, India. Indeed she has made a statement for all Indian women and made them proud.

When she chose to do aeronautical engineering at Punjab University, in India, the principal told her that it was not suitable for women and advised her to opt for something more suitable. A brilliant A – level student, Kalpana insisted on aeronautical engineering or nothing. She believed in 'doing something that you like'. Her family was also shocked with her choice of going to Punjab University which is in faraway Chandigarh. Parents relatives and friends all tried to dissuade her. Her determination saw her through. At last, her parents relented but her mother insisted on following her. Things went smoothly and

she completed her course. Then she dropped another bombshell. She wanted to go to the States to further studies.

"How can you send your unmarried daughter aboard all alone," demanded a family friend. Someone suggested an arranged marriage to someone in the US. Kalpana would have none of it. She credits her family for their support. "They are conservative but very different from others. There wasn't any no, absolutely not." You could always say, 'but I want to do it.' If you said it enough times, you would have it. In families that are truly conservative, you don't even dare ask. She arrived in the US in 1982 to study at the University of Texas, graduating in 1984. She went on to get her Ph.D in Aerospace Engineering at the University of Colorado in 1988. In between her studies, she qualified for a pilot's license in 1987. She then began to think seriously about applying to the space shuttle program.

She was among six civilian finalists who were selected by the National Aeronautics and Space administration (NASA) after several rounds of interviews and rigorous physical and medical evaluations at the Johnson Space Centre. NASA had selected a total of six civilians and thirteen military officers from a pool of almost 300 aspiring applicants. When they informed her in December 1994 that she had been selected, she was already a vice-president and research scientist at Overset Methods Incorporated.

She began her special training on March 6, at the Johnson Space Centre in Houston. The first year of training introduces candidates to all NASA centres, instructs them in land and sea survival and prepares them for operating aircraft. After successful completion of training, the 'candidates' become 'astronauts' and are assigned specific jobs and duties within the NASA Astronauts Office to further prepare them as shuttle crew members.

On 19 November, 1997, Kalpana at 35 became India's first woman astronaut on the space shuttle. Columbia which headed for space. She was the only woman in the six-member crew. As a mission specialist, she is responsible for planning crew activity, monitoring consumable shuttle items and conducting experiments. She has this to say to women reading about her determined journey into space. "That's the message I want to give to other women : Do something because you really want to do it. Even if it is a goal which is not necessarily within reach."

A typical space shuttle mission lasts 8-12 days and Kalpana hopes to participate in several trips over many years. Her husband is enthusiastic about Kalpana dream. They have relocated to Houston where he works as a flight instructor. The rest of her family who reside in India are proud of her and support her endeavour.

a) What is notable about Kalpana's achievement?

Answer:

Kalpana Chawla, an aerospace engineer has become the first Indo-American woman to venture into space. It is a notable achievement for a lady from a male-dominated India

b) How did Kalpana overcome the objections of her family and friends?

Answer:

Kalpana's determination to do what she really liked, to not give up on her dreams and to continuously try to persuade her family to agree to her choices helped her overcome the objections of her family and friends.

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c) What was the objection to Kalpana's going aboard and what was the suggestion?

Answer:

The objection raised to Kalpana going abroad was that she was an unmarried girl and a should not be going abroad all alone. The suggestion to this problem was to arrange her marriage to a suitable boy living in the US.

d) Name two things that the candidates learn during the first year of training.

Answer:

The first year of training introduces candidates to all NASA centres, instructs them in land and sea survival

e) How did the principal advise Kalpana when she wanted to do aeronautical engineering?

Answer:

The principal told Kalpana that aeronautical engineering was not suitable for women and advised her to opt for something more suitable.

f) Choose a word or phrase from the first three paragraphs that is similar in meaning to the following words:

- i) Choose
- ii) gave in
- iii) traditional

Answer:

i) opt, ii) relented, iii) conservative

g) Write a précis of the passage and give a suitable title.

Answer:

Kalpana Chawla, has become the first Indo-American woman to venture into space. Born in India to a conservative family, she faced resistance when she opted to study aeronautical engineering. She completed her studies in the US. She also obtained a pilot's license in 1987. She was among six civilian finalists who were selected by the NASA for their space program. On 19 November, 1997, Kalpana became India's first woman astronaut in space.

13. Write an essay on any one topic given below:

a) Importance of leisure hours in life

[WBUT 2019]

Answer:

Importance of leisure hours in life

Taking part in recreational activities especially those performed outside can go a long way in improving your physical wellness. In fact, individuals who take part in outdoor activities tend to have fewer doctor visits, low systolic blood pressure and even low body mass compared to those who do not. Here are some of the benefits which you are set to enjoy by making physical activities part of your daily routine.

Lowers Stress and Depression: Mental wellness is among the most important parts of your overall body health as it impacts the physical well-being. Leisure gives you the opportunity to find the right balance in life while also controlling how you get to spend your time. This is important as it makes one feel overwhelmed by obligations.

Improved Quality of Life: Making recreation activities a help in creating a balance between pressures from academic work with mental and physical well-being. In addition to this, it also offers numerous benefits including enriching self-expression, creating creative expressions and self-fulfilment.

Builds Family Unity: Families that spend time together tend to be closer and more cohesive. This is true with both married couples and parent-child relationships.

Aids Positivity: Daily stress from work tends to bring a feeling of negativity and increased stress levels. recreational activities will get you to think better thus performing your duties effectively.

Health and Physical Benefits: People nowadays hardly find time to take part in some leisure due to their busy schedule. Absence of physical activities may in the end cause serious health issues such as obesity and heart related problems. Taking part in recreational or leisure activities will help you improve your fitness levels thus maintaining your body's health. Moving is known to play a key role when it comes to stretching muscles and improving flexibility. Whenever you engage in active activities such as skating, walking, Yoga and swimming, all your muscles in the body are put into use.

Enhances One's Communication Skills and Self-Esteem: Spending quality leisure as a group is important as it has the capabilities of enhancing the communication skills and self-esteem of individuals involved.

Recreational and leisure activities are necessary if you want to maintain a healthy living. However, you must make sure that you are taking part in leisure activities which you are good at since you will find them to be enjoyable. By doing so, you are sure of getting all the benefits that leisure activities have to offer without necessarily having to break a sweat.

b) Employment prospects in the IT industry

[WBUT 2019]

Answer:

Employment prospects in the IT industry

With the increasing focus on technology across industries, the IT/software sector will continue to create the maximum jobs in the country. The booming IT/software sector reigns supreme by continuing to create the maximum jobs in the country. The adoption of emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI), machine learning, and robotics for automation is driving the industry's growth. Besides hiring afresh, Indian IT companies will continue to spend on upskilling employees. In 2019, this is estimated to increase by around 20%. Some of the areas wherein positive growth in hiring is expected are mathematics-, architecture-, and engineering-related fields. Salaries are also expected to grow in tandem at a 13% average rise, at par with 2018. However, a few jobs involving data analytics, machine learning, and AI development will fetch higher salary bands, the company said. By 2020, job creation in the Indian IT sector is expected to surge to about

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2 million new additions worldwide, of which around 13% will be in India itself. A potentially strong area of employment will be data analytics, an increasingly crucial field across industries. Other prominent roles in demand will be computer software developers, information security analysts, machine learning, mobility, cloud engineers, network analysts, and cybersecurity experts. Cloud computing opportunities will increase by 23%. Startups will be strong contributors to generating employment in the next two years because of their expanded adoption of AI, robotics, blockchain, and IoT. However, there still is a mismatch between candidates' skills and industry requirement. Jobs roles in IT have become multi-dimensional and the industry needs to take a generation leap in re-skilling its employees. To facilitate advance skilling, it is also crucial for organisations to hire highly skilled and technologically sound HR representatives as well as development specialists who can hire the right talent in the ever competitive market.

c) Pollution crisis in urban areas

[WBUT 2019]

Answer:

Pollution crisis in urban areas

The presence of poisonous, contaminating substances in the environment around us creates havoc to the dwelling space and introduces harmful and non-biodegradable substances. These harmful chemical laden toxic elements cause pollution. The concern in the urban areas is more serious because the greenery belt in the metros cities is severely low and pollution levels are very high. Urban areas have higher density of vehicles, more emissions from factories and industries, higher rate of food adulteration, etc. Due to this, people are suffering from deadly diseases, like cancer and asthma, acid rains are becoming more common. Burning of farm residue cause major pollution. They have very high small micro level particles in them that can choke our lungs and trouble the respiratory system. Very high levels of toxic elements like nitrogen, phosphorus etc. is found in this kind of smoke emitting out of residue burning. The environment is degraded by pollutants emitted out from the fumes of exhausts fitted to vehicles. Economic liberation in urban areas has made people more outgoing in their choices of vehicles. The motor or vehicular pollutants include elements like carbon monoxide, toxic nitrogen oxide, ammonia, high levels of hydrogen and sulphur dioxide. The greenhouse emissions can actually cause a lot of destruction to our atmosphere. Petrol and diesel, when burnt, release harmful by-products into the environment. Plastic is one of the biggest source of urban pollution today. We have plastic toothbrushes, plastic mugs, plastic pens etc. Every year along big sea shores, we find whales falling dead on the shore with a stomach filled with tons of plastic. So plastic is definitely not a good choice and we can replace it with other alternatives. Every house, be it in urban or rural background churns out piles of waste from their homes every day. Scientific way of waste disposal could put an end to soil pollution and attract better ways of handling and treating waste and disposed resources. We can replace our plastic bags and use paper bags in their place. We have to ensure safe disposal of paints, varnishes, worn out batteries. Pollution can cause many deadly diseases to both humans and animals like bronchitis and asthma. Water borne contaminants can easily cause cholera and diphtheria. Pollution is a global crisis today. Right from the garbage that we throw from our houses, to the sewage and industrial

wastes let out from factories and industries, we can find pollution everywhere. Urban cities in India score much higher in terms of pollution levels compared to rural counterparts.

d) 'Social media' is a selfish medium.

[WBUT 2019]

Answer:

'Social media' is a selfish medium

Youngsters of today are very popular on social platforms like Facebook, Twitter, WhatsApp, Instagram etc. These handles provide the youth with an opportunity to keep contact with their alumni network, post latest updates about their life, connect with friends from remote places, post pictures and so on. Earlier, people used to communicate with friends over letters and later through e-mails and chats. Now this has been made easy through social media where every second of a person's life can be updated on an easy platform. Social media platforms basically use the broadcast technology to pop a single message to a network of relevant members, who the sender wishes to share his message with. This is where social media plays a selfish role, in that the individual forgets that it is only a small part of his life and he cannot put his whole life on showcase over these channels. Taking selfies is the most happening thing of today. There are people who dress up every morning just to take a selfie and replace it with their earlier photograph on their respective accounts. It may further lead to obsession and may cause disturbances in the normal functioning of the individual as well. Be it a holiday with our family, a festival at home or something as simple as buying a new dress, the first thing that comes on people's minds is to promote it on their respective social media account. Not just that, people form groups with their like minded friends and talk about various topics. In other words, it becomes a medium of expression to voice your opinions about a currently happening debate or a current topic in the country that is of rage with the youth. People talk to any extent on these platforms without thinking of the consequences. It's good to express our opinions but stretching beyond boundaries is a bad thing, a selfish thing. When things go out of hand, people face dire consequences. This kind of promotion being initiated on these social media platforms and later provoking people to speak blindly causes many problems in people's lives. The people who usually shy away from sharing views openly with people, are active on social sites because that provides a voice to their opinions. Social media in a way is providing them a 'safe escape' from the real world into the virtual world. Though there's nothing wrong in it, but in a way, it is causing communication gap between people and generations. We all know that festivals, celebrations and get together are meant to create memories. But the selfishness of social media can be sensed from the fact that making memories is overtaken by uploading pictures and selfies. Pictures are clicked not with the purpose of cherishing them, but to garner more likes and comments after they are uploaded on facebook and instagram. People who witness road accidents, before lending any help to the injured person, get busy in clicking pictures and making videos. This in a way undermines the value of someone's life where the delicate and precious fabric of society is getting weakened. These changes are occurring because of the way social media (it's platforms

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like facebook, twitter, instagram, youtube) is being used. And because of this it is often criticized to be a "Selfish Medium".

14. Read the following passage and answer the following questions: [WBUT 2019]
"I Have a Dream" is a public speech delivered by American civil rights activist Martin Luther King Jr. during the March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom on August 28, 1963, in which he calls for an end to racism in the United States and called for civil and economic rights. Delivered to over 250,000 civil rights supporters from the steps of the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C., the speech was a defining moment of the civil rights movement.

Beginning with a reference to the Emancipation Proclamation, which freed million of slaves in 1863, King observes that: "one hundred years later, the Negro still is not free". Toward the end of the speech, King departed from his prepared text for a partly improvised peroration on the theme "I have a dream", promoted by Mahalia Jackson's cry: "Tell them about the dream, Martin!" In this part of the speech, which most excited the listeners and has now become the most famous is King described his dreams of freedom and equality arising from a land of slavery and hatred. Jon Meacham writes that, "With a single phrase, Martin Luther King Jr. joined Jefferson and Lincoln in the ranks of men who've shaped modern America". The speech was ranked the top American speech of the 20th century in a 1999 poll of scholars of public address.

a) What issues does Martin Luther King's speech address?

Answer:

Martin Luther King's speech calls for an end to racism in the United States and called for civil and economic rights.

b) Who pushes King to speak: "I have a dream"?

Answer:

Mahalia Jackson pushes King to speak.

c) What did King observe and what does the most famous part of his speech describe?

Answer:

King observes that "one hundred years later, the Negro still is not free".

The part of the speech, which most excited the listeners and has now become the most famous is King described his dreams of freedom and equality arising from a land of slavery and hatred.

d) In front of whom does King speak?

Answer:

The speech was delivered by King to over 250,000 civil rights supporters from the steps of the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C.

e) From the last paragraph, give one word for 'to leave' and make a sentence with it.

Answer:

Departed – After the prosecution by the jury, Antonio departed from the courtroom with a heavy heart.

f) **Make précis of the passage given above and give a suitable title.**

Answer:

The Freedom to Dream

“I Have a Dream” is a public speech delivered to over 250,000 civil rights supporters by American civil rights activist Martin Luther King Jr. in which he calls for an end to racism in the United States. King observes that: “one hundred years later, the Negro still is not free”. Toward the end, King improvised saying “I have a dream”, promoted by Mahalia Jackson’s cry: “Tell them about the dream, Martin !” King described his dreams of freedom and equality arising from a land of slavery and hatred. The speech was ranked the top American speech of the 20th century in a 1999 poll of scholars of public address.

15. Write a job application and provide your Resume in response to the following advertisement on May 2, 2019 in The Telegraph:

An MNC has vacancy for the post of a Junior Manager where the company would be recruiting an engineer with three years' experience. Apply within 21 days to the H.R. Manager, Corporate Computer Communications. GM Block, Salt Lake, Kolkata-700 091. [WBUT 2019]

Answer:

Resume

PERSONAL DETAILS:

Name : Ankita Biswas
Father's Name : Achintya Kr. Biswas
Age : 25 yrs.
Date of Birth : 19th October, 1993
Marital status : Single
Address : 8/2A Haralal Das Lane, Kolkata 700006
Contact no. : 033 25426377, 9127374738
Email id : ank_bws94@gmail.com

ACADEMIC DETAILS:

Degrees	Board/University	Year of passing	Percentage/ Grade
10th standard	ICSE	2009	91%
12th standard	ISC	2011	85%
B.E. (Comp Sc.)	Jadavpur University	2015	77%

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES:

- Secretary for the college fest for 2 years
- Editor of college magazine for 2 years
- Number of participation and achievements in debates and compeering in both school and college

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- Participated in the various inter-college exhibitions and competitions.

EXPERIENCE:

- Internship from May 2015 – October 2015 at ATL Labs, Mumbai
- Team member from November 2015 – January 2018 at Tata Infotech, Kolkata
- Team leader from February 2018 – Present at Wipro, Kolkata

Covering letter

To
The Manager – HR
Corporate Computer Communications.
GM Block,
Sector V
Kolkata-700091

8.05.2019

Dear Sir/Madam

I had come across your advertisement in The Times of India dated 18.09.2018 seeking an Assistant Officer IT. I would like to apply for the same. I herewith attach my resume along with this application. I have consistently performed well academically and have shown equal prowess in co-curricular and team activities, as mentioned in my resume. I wish to continue proving the same and would be looking forward for an opportunity to a personal interview.

Thanking you,
Yours faithfully
Ankita Biswas